IELTS LISTENING · SPELLING

7-Day IELTS Listening Spelling Mastery

A Comprehensive Workbook to Eliminate Common Spelling Mistakes

1	2	3	4	5	6	7
-ant / -ent	-ance / -ence	-able / -ible	-ary / -ery & more	Double, silent, vowels	120-word bank	Singular & plural

Words covered	**450+** words with IPA, meaning, example and common mistake
Practice	40+ exercises · 8 audio dictations · 7 daily assessments · Final Mastery Test
Spelling	British English (IELTS accepts British or American, so be consistent)
Personal	★ marks words **you** have misspelled before

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Importance, difference, patience or patients?

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Test — **Final Mastery Test**
60 marks covering all seven days

Bank — **Real Answer Words: Cambridge 10–19**
623 real gap-fill answer words from Cambridge 10–19, most frequent first, with 7 dictations

Key — **Answer Key**
Answers to every exercise, assessment and dictation

Log — **Trackers and Error Log**
Score tracker, error log, spaced review

Start How to Use This Workbook

Why your spelling goes wrong in Listening

You usually **hear** the word correctly. The mistake happens in the 2 seconds between hearing it and writing it. There are four main reasons:

1. **The weak vowel /ə/ (schwa).** In English, unstressed syllables are reduced to a short, lazy /ə/ sound. import**ant** and differ**ent** both end in /ənt/, and perform**ance** and exist**ence** both end in /əns/. **Your ear cannot tell you the letter**, so you need a rule, a word family or a memory trick instead.
2. **Letters that are written but not pronounced:** silent letters (recei**p**t, We**d**nesday) and double consonants (a**cc**o**mm**odation), which sound exactly like single ones.
3. **Plural endings that disappear in fast speech.** In "*two desks*" the final /s/ is almost swallowed, and in "*tourists stay*" the two /s/ sounds merge into one. You hear one book but the answer is *books*.
4. **Words that sound the same but are spelt differently:** *patients / patience*, *stationery / stationary*, *weather / whether*.

This workbook gives you a **rule, a word family or a memory trick** for each of these. With those, you stop guessing.

The 12 problems this workbook fixes

#	Problem	Example	Your own mistake ★	Fixed on
1	-ant or -ent	import**ant** / differ**ent**	elegent → **elegant**, convienont → **convenient**	Day 1
2	-ance or -ence	perform**ance** / exist**ence**	santance → **sentence**, experioence → **experience**	Day 2
3	-able or -ible	avail**able** / poss**ible**	valueable → **valuable**, reposibility → **responsibility**	Day 3
4	-ary or -ery	libr**ary** / station**ery**	entre → **entry**	Day 4
5	-tion or -sion	informa**tion** / deci**sion**	conculation → **conclusion**	Day 4
6	Similar vowels	sep**a**rate, d**e**finitely	hasitate → **hesitate**, pession → **passion**	Day 5
7	Double consonants	a**cc**o**mm**odation	Mamals → **mammals**, footbal → **football**	Day 5
8	Silent letters	recei**p**t, We**d**nesday	rythm → **rhythm**	Day 5
9	Singular or plural	one *sheep*, two *sheep*	mammals (plural -s missed)	Day 7
10	Countable or uncountable	*information* (never *informations*)	schoolworks → **schoolwork**	Day 7
11	Extra or missing -s / -es	*a ten-minute walk*, *potatoes*	teams player → **team player**	Day 7
12	Sound-alike words	patients / patience	rate → **rare**, carrer → **career**	Days 2, 5, 7

★ = a word you have actually misspelled (from your Spelling Fix List). These are marked ★ wherever they appear in the workbook.

IELTS Listening spelling rules you must know

> ⚠️ **A wrongly spelt answer scores zero**, even if you heard it perfectly. A missing or extra plural **-s** also scores zero.

- **British or American spelling** is accepted (*colour* or *color*). Choose one and stay consistent. This workbook uses **British** spelling.
- **Capital letters** don't matter on the answer sheet. On paper, writing every answer in CAPITALS is allowed and can make your letters clearer.
- A **hyphenated word** counts as one word: *ten-minute* = 1 word.
- **Numbers** can be written as figures: *15* is safer than *fifteen*.
- **Words given in the question are spelt correctly for you.** If the answer word is printed in the question paper, copy it from there.
- When you **transfer answers** (paper test: 10 minutes; computer test: 2 minutes to check), check every answer letter by letter, and check its ending: **-s, -es, -ed, -ing, -ly**.

Your 7-day plan (about 85 minutes a day)

Day	Topic	Words	Main skill
1	-ant vs -ent	40	Word families, the "hard/soft c and g" rule
2	-ance vs -ence	42	Linking nouns to Day 1 adjectives, sound-alike pairs
3	-able vs -ible	42	The "whole word" rule, dropping -e, y → i
4	-ary vs -ery and 9 other endings	40 + 9 mini-lessons	-al/-el, -ic/-ical, -cial/-tial, -ous/-ious, -tion/-sion, -ful, -or/-our, -er/-re, -ise/-ize
5	Double letters, silent letters, vowels	45	ie/ei, ea/ee, ai/ay, ou/ow, British spelling
6	IELTS Listening vocabulary bank	120	10 topic areas from Sections 1–4
7	Singular and plural traps	150+ forms	Hearing and choosing the right number
+	Final Mastery Test	60 marks	Everything
+	Real Answer Words (Cambridge 10–19)	623	The 132 most frequent real answers in 7 daily blocks of about 19 words, plus an A–Z list

The daily routine

Step	Time	What to do
1. Learn	20 min	Read the rules. Say every word in the table **aloud, syllable by syllable**.
2. Look-Say-Cover-Write-Check	15 min	For each word you don't know: look, say, cover, write from memory, check letter by letter.
3. Exercises	20 min	Do the written exercises **without looking back**. Mark them with the Answer Key.
4. Dictation	10 min	Play the day's audio file. Write each word once. Mark it.

Step	Time	What to do
5. Assessment	10 min	Do the daily assessment. Record your score in the tracker at the back.
6. Real answer words	10 min	Learn today's block from the **Real Answer Words** chapter and play its dictation.

Audio files are in `Listening/Spelling Workbook/audio/` (Day1_Dictation.wav … Final_Test_Dictation.wav, and AnswerWords_Block1–7.wav). Each lesson word is read with a short sentence, and then there is a pause for you to write. Don't look at the word list while you listen. If you have no audio, ask a friend to read the dictation script from the Answer Key.

Spaced review: test every word you got wrong again **after 1 day, 3 days and 7 days**. A word is learnt when you spell it correctly in all three tests. Write your wrong words in the **Error Log** at the back of this workbook, and add any Listening mistakes to section 8 of your Spelling Fix List.

Symbols used in this workbook

Symbol	Meaning
★	A word **you** have misspelled before
/ˈ/	IPA stress mark: the next syllable is stressed
n · *v* · *adj* · *adv*	noun · verb · adjective · adverb
❌ → ✅	Common wrong spelling → correct spelling
💡	Memory trick
⚠️	Exam warning
●	(Real Answer Words) also taught in Days 1–7

Day 1 -ANT vs -ENT

Learning objectives

By the end of today you will be able to:

- spell **43 common -ant / -ent words** used in IELTS Listening;
- choose the ending using **5 rules** instead of guessing;
- turn every adjective into its noun (**important → importance**), which prepares you for Day 2;
- understand why **pronunciation alone cannot tell you the ending**.

Why your ear can't help you

⚠️ **-ant and -ent sound exactly the same.** Both are unstressed, so both are pronounced /ənt/ (or just /nt/).

Word	IPA	Ending you hear	Ending you write
pleas**ant**	/ˈpleznt/	/nt/	**-ant**
pres**ent**	/ˈpreznt/	/nt/	**-ent**
dist**ant**	/ˈdɪstənt/	/ənt/	**-ant**
consist**ent**	/kənˈsɪstənt/	/ənt/	**-ent**
import**ant**	/ɪmˈpɔːtnt/	/nt/	**-ant**
pat**ient**	/ˈpeɪʃnt/	/nt/	**-ent**

Pleasant and *present* almost rhyme, but one is -ant and the other is -ent. So **you need a rule, a word family or a memory trick.**

The 5 rules

Rule 1: Use the word family (the most reliable rule).
If you know a related word ending in **-ance, -ancy or -ation**, write **-ant**. If you know one ending in **-ence or -ency**, write **-ent**.

You know…	so you write…	You know…	so you write…
import**ance**	import**ant**	differ**ence**	differ**ent**
toler**ation**	toler**ant**	frequ**ency**	frequ**ent**
vac**ancy**	vac**ant**	efficiency	efficient
hesit**ation**	hesit**ant**	intellig**ence**	intellig**ent**

Rule 2: Verbs ending in -ate or -y usually give -ant.
toler**ate** → toler**ant** · domin**ate** → domin**ant** · hesit**ate** → hesit**ant** · particip**ate** → particip**ant** · migr**ate** → migr**ant** · vac**ate** → vac**ant**

appl**y** → applic**ant** · rel**y** → reli**ant** · compl**y** → compli**ant** · def**y** → defi**ant**

Rule 3: A hard c or g sound before the ending gives -ant; a soft c or g sound gives -ent.
English **c** and **g** sound soft (/s/ and /dʒ/) before **e**, and hard (/k/ and /g/) before **a**. The ending keeps the sound you hear.

Hard sound → -ant	Soft sound → -ent
signifi**c**ant /k/	re**c**ent /s/
appli**c**ant /k/	inno**c**ent /s/
va**c**ant /k/	de**c**ent /s/
ele**g**ant /g/ ★	intelli**g**ent /dʒ/
arro**g**ant /g/	ur**g**ent /dʒ/
extrava**g**ant /g/	dili**g**ent /dʒ/ ★

💡 *Significent* would be pronounced "signifi-SENT". The **a** keeps the /k/ sound.

Rule 4: After *qu* and after *-id-*, write -ent.
fre**qu**ent · conse**qu**ent · subse**qu**ent · elo**qu**ent

confi**d**ent · evi**d**ent · resi**d**ent · presi**d**ent · acci**d**ent · inci**d**ent

Rule 5: Verbs ending in *-ist* give -ent, except two.
consist → consist**ent** · insist → insist**ent** · persist → persist**ent** · exist → (non-)exist**ent**

⚠️ **Exceptions:** ass**ist** → assist**ant**, res**ist** → resist**ant**.

💡 "*The **A**ssistant and the **R**esistant soldier are **A**nts.*"

Important exceptions and traps

- **People nouns are mixed.** Many end in -ant (*assistant, applicant, participant, accountant, consultant, tenant, servant, inhabitant, immigrant, attendant*), but some end in -ent (*student, resident, president, agent, opponent, client*). Learn these as a list.
- **Same sound, different word (British English):**
- **dependant** (*n*, a person who depends on you, e.g. a child) / **dependent** (*adj*). *I have two dependants. She is dependent on her parents.*
- **confidant** (*n*, a person you tell secrets to) / **confident** (*adj*, sure of yourself).
- **currant** (*n*, a small dried fruit) / **current** (*adj*, happening now; *n*, a flow of water or electricity).
- **One word, two pronunciations: present** /ˈpreznt/ (*adj*, here now; *n*, a gift) and **present** /prɪˈzent/ (*v*, to show). The spelling stays the same.

Word list A: -ANT words (20)

Word · IPA · Part of speech	Meaning	Example sentence	❌ Common mistake
important /ɪmˈpɔːtnt/ *adj*	of great value or necessity	It's **important** to bring your passport.	importent
assistant /əˈsɪstənt/ *n*	a person who helps someone	Ask the shop **assistant** for help.	assistent
participant /pɑːˈtɪsɪpənt/ *n*	a person who takes part	Each **participant** gets a certificate.	participent, particepant
significant /sɪgˈnɪfɪkənt/ *adj*	large or important enough to notice	There was a **significant** drop in sales.	significent
pleasant /ˈpleznt/ *adj*	nice, enjoyable	The weather was **pleasant**.	plesant, pleasent
distant /ˈdɪstənt/ *adj*	far away	They live in a **distant** village.	distent
constant /ˈkɒnstənt/ *adj*	not changing; happening all the time	Keep the fridge at a **constant** temperature.	constent

Word · IPA · Part of speech	Meaning	Example sentence	❌ Common mistake
resistant /rɪˈzɪstənt/ *adj*	not damaged by something	The watch is water-**resistant**.	resistent
brilliant /ˈbrɪliənt/ *adj*	very clever; excellent	She had a **brilliant** idea.	briliant
relevant /ˈreləvənt/ *adj*	connected to the subject	Only include **relevant** details.	relevent, relavant
elegant ★ /ˈelɪgənt/ *adj*	stylish and attractive	The hotel lobby is very **elegant**.	elegent
vacant /ˈveɪkənt/ *adj*	empty; not being used	Is this seat **vacant**?	vacent
applicant /ˈæplɪkənt/ *n*	a person who applies for a job or place	Each **applicant** has an interview.	applicent
tolerant /ˈtɒlərənt/ *adj*	accepting of other people or conditions	This plant is **tolerant** of dry soil.	tolerent
dominant /ˈdɒmɪnənt/ *adj*	strongest; most important	Rice is the **dominant** crop here.	dominent
hesitant /ˈhezɪtənt/ *adj*	slow to act because unsure	He was **hesitant** to sign the contract.	hesitent, hasitant
abundant /əˈbʌndənt/ *adj*	more than enough	Fish are **abundant** in this river.	abundent
accountant /əˈkaʊntənt/ *n*	a person who manages money records	My **accountant** checks my tax.	acountant, accountent
tenant /ˈtenənt/ *n*	a person who rents a home	The **tenant** pays rent monthly.	tenent
reluctant /rɪˈlʌktənt/ *adj*	not willing	She was **reluctant** to move house.	reluctent

Word list B: -ENT words (23)

Word · IPA · Part of speech	Meaning	Example sentence	❌ Common mistake
different /ˈdɪfrənt/ *adj*	not the same	We need a **different** room.	diferent, differant
independent /ˌɪndɪˈpendənt/ *adj*	not controlled by or relying on others	She is an **independent** traveller.	independant
convenient ★ /kənˈviːniənt/ *adj*	easy, useful, suitable	Is 3 pm **convenient** for you?	convinient, convenent
confident /ˈkɒnfɪdənt/ *adj*	sure of yourself	I feel **confident** about the test.	confidant (= a different word)
intelligent /ɪnˈtelɪdʒənt/ *adj*	clever	Crows are **intelligent** birds.	inteligent, intelligant
permanent /ˈpɜːmənənt/ *adj*	lasting for ever / a long time	Is the job **permanent**?	permanant, permenent
excellent /ˈeksələnt/ *adj*	extremely good	The service was **excellent**.	excelent, excellant
ancient /ˈeɪnʃənt/ *adj*	very old	We saw an **ancient** castle.	anchient, ancent
patient /ˈpeɪʃnt/ *adj, n*	calm when waiting; a person in hospital	The doctor has ten **patients**.	pacient, patiant
absent /ˈæbsənt/ *adj*	not present	Two students were **absent**.	absant

Word · IPA · Part of speech	Meaning	Example sentence	❌ Common mistake
present /ˈpreznt/ *adj, n*	here now; a gift	All members must be **present**.	presant
efficient /ɪˈfɪʃnt/ *adj*	working well without waste	LED bulbs are more **efficient**.	efficent, eficient
frequent /ˈfriːkwənt/ *adj*	happening often	Buses are **frequent** at rush hour.	frequant, frequint
consistent /kənˈsɪstənt/ *adj*	always the same	His work is **consistent**.	consistant
dependent /dɪˈpendənt/ *adj*	needing someone or something	The town is **dependent** on tourism.	dependant (= noun in British English)
competent /ˈkɒmpɪtənt/ *adj*	having enough skill	You must be **competent** in Excel.	competant, competint
diligent ★ /ˈdɪlɪdʒənt/ *adj*	hard-working and careful	She's a **diligent** student.	deligent, diligant
urgent /ˈɜːdʒənt/ *adj*	needing action now	This is an **urgent** message.	urgant
recent /ˈriːsnt/ *adj*	happening a short time ago	Bring a **recent** photo.	resent, recant
apparent /əˈpærənt/ *adj*	clear; seeming true	The problem became **apparent**.	aparent, apparant
sufficient /səˈfɪʃnt/ *adj*	enough	There is **sufficient** parking.	suficient, sufficent
resident /ˈrezɪdənt/ *n*	a person who lives in a place	Parking is for **residents** only.	residant
current /ˈkʌrənt/ *adj*	happening now	What is your **current** address?	currant (= dried fruit)

Word families: adjective → noun

You will use this table again tomorrow. **The letter never changes inside a family:** -ant gives -ance/-ancy, and -ent gives -ence/-ency.

-ANT adjective	Noun	-ENT adjective	Noun
important	import**ance**	different	differ**ence**
significant	signific**ance**	independent	independ**ence**
distant	dist**ance**	confident	confid**ence**
resistant	resist**ance**	intelligent	intellig**ence**
relevant	relev**ance**	excellent	excell**ence**
brilliant	brilli**ance**	patient	pati**ence**
elegant	eleg**ance**	absent	abs**ence**
tolerant	toler**ance**	present	pres**ence**
dominant	domin**ance**	convenient	conveni**ence**
abundant	abund**ance**	competent	compet**ence**
reluctant	reluct**ance**	permanent	perman**ence**
vacant	vac**ancy**	frequent	frequ**ency**
hesitant	hesit**ancy**	efficient	effici**ency**

-ANT adjective	Noun	-ENT adjective	Noun
constant	const**ancy**	consistent	consist**ency**
assistant (*n*)	assist**ance**	urgent	urg**ency**

Common mistakes and corrections

❌ Wrong	✅ Right	Why
importent	**important**	import**ance** → -ant (Rule 1)
independant	**independent**	No **a** anywhere after *ind-*: i-n-d-**e**-p-**e**-n-d-**e**-n-t
significent	**significant**	Hard /k/ sound → -ant (Rule 3)
inteligent	**intelligent**	Double **ll**, soft g → -ent
assistent	**assistant**	Exception to the *-ist* rule (Rule 5)
consistant	**consistent**	consist → -ent (Rule 5)
frequant	**frequent**	After *qu* → -ent (Rule 4)
elegent ★	**elegant**	Hard /g/ → -ant (Rule 3)
convienont ★	**convenient**	con + **ven** + **i** + **ent**
deligent ★	**diligent**	**di**-li-gent; soft g → -ent

Memory techniques

- 💡 **Hard sound → a, soft sound → e.** Say the letter before the ending: signifi**c**ant (/k/) → **a**; re**c**ent (/s/) → **e**.
- 💡 **"An Assistant, An Applicant and An Accountant are All Ants."** They work hard, like ants, and they all end in -ANT.
- 💡 **independent has no a.** Every vowel after *ind-* is **e**: ind**e**p**e**nd**e**nt.
- 💡 **per-MAN-ent.** Find the *man* in *permanent*, then add **-ent**.
- 💡 **EXCEL + LENT.** *Excellent = excel + lent*.
- 💡 **An ELEGANT ANT.** ★ Picture an ant in a suit.
- 💡 **con-VEN-I-ENT.** ★ Say all four syllables slowly when you write it.
- 💡 **Ask yourself "what's the noun?"** If you know *frequency*, *frequent* must end in -ent.

Exercise 1.1: Complete each word with -ant or -ent

1. import_____
2. differ_____
3. assist_____
4. conveni_____
5. particip_____
6. intellig_____
7. signific_____
8. perman_____
9. pleas_____
10. effici_____
11. relev_____
12. consist_____
13. resist_____
14. independ_____
15. eleg_____
16. dilig_____
17. applic_____
18. excell_____
19. toler_____
20. compet_____

Exercise 1.2: Write the noun

1. important → _____
2. different → _____
3. confident → _____
4. independent → _____
5. resistant → _____
6. patient → _____
7. absent → _____
8. frequent → _____
9. efficient → _____
10. relevant → _____
11. significant → _____
12. consistent → _____
13. intelligent → _____
14. vacant → _____
15. permanent → _____

Exercise 1.3: Make an -ant or -ent word from the verb

1. assist → _____ (*person*)
2. participate → _____ (*person*)
3. apply → _____ (*person*)
4. depend → _____ (*adj*)
5. resist → _____ (*adj*)
6. consult → _____ (*person*)
7. differ → _____ (*adj*)
8. tolerate → _____ (*adj*)
9. reside → _____ (*person*)
10. hesitate → _____ (*adj*)
11. insist → _____ (*adj*)
12. rely → _____ (*adj*)

Exercise 1.4: Find and correct the spelling mistake

Each sentence has **one** spelling mistake. Underline it and write the correct word.

1. The library is very convenent for students. _____
2. Please speak to my assistent at reception. _____
3. The weather has been quite pleasent this week. _____
4. She is a very confidant speaker. _____
5. All participents must register by Friday. _____
6. The museum has an excellant collection of coins. _____
7. He has been absant from three lectures. _____
8. The building is resistent to earthquakes. _____
9. This is a permenant position. _____
10. Buses are more frequant in the morning. _____
11. The hotel was clean and elegent. _____
12. She is the most inteligent student in the class. _____

Exercise 1.5: IELTS-style note completion

Complete the notes with a word from the box. Use each word once.

> ancient · assistant · competent · constant · distant · independent · patient · present · relevant · significant

Volunteer Programme: Notes

1. Job title: Library _____

2. Visitors can see _____ coins from Roman times.
3. Students must bring _____ documents only.
4. There has been a _____ increase in bike users.
5. The temperature inside the store room stays _____.
6. Learners should be _____ and able to work alone.
7. Helpers must be _____ with older visitors.
8. Every volunteer should be _____ at 9 am on Monday.
9. Applicants must be _____ in using spreadsheets.
10. The farm is in a _____ part of the island.

Dictation 1

► Play **Day1_Dictation.wav**. Write each word once. Don't look at the word lists.

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____
6. _____
7. _____
8. _____
9. _____
10. _____
11. _____
12. _____
13. _____
14. _____
15. _____
16. _____
17. _____
18. _____
19. _____
20. _____

Day 1 Assessment (20 marks)

A. Circle the correct spelling. (10 marks)

1. a) importent b) important c) importint
2. a) diferent b) differant c) different
3. a) convenient b) convinient c) convenyent
4. a) participent b) participant c) particepant
5. a) inteligent b) intelligant c) intelligent
6. a) permanant b) permanent c) permenent
7. a) relevant b) relevent c) relavant
8. a) efficent b) efficient c) eficient
9. a) consistant b) consistent c) concistent
10. a) briliant b) brilliant c) brillient

B. Write the noun. (5 marks)

11. independent → _____
12. significant → _____
13. patient → _____

14. relevant → _____

15. confident → _____

C. Tick (✓) the word if it is correct. If it is wrong, correct it. (5 marks)

16. resistent _____

17. competent _____

18. distent _____

19. absant _____

20. elegant _____

My score: _____ / 20 · 18–20: well done, move on · 14–17: repeat Exercise 1.4 and the ★ words · below 14: repeat the dictation tomorrow before Day 2

Day 2 -ANCE vs -ENCE

Learning objectives

By the end of today you will be able to:

- spell **42 common -ance / -ence nouns**;
- use yesterday's adjectives to choose the ending (**different** → **difference**);
- choose the ending from the **verb** (**appear** → **appearance**, **exist** → **existence**);
- tell apart sound-alike pairs that are a big IELTS trap: **patience / patients**, **assistance / assistants**.

Why your ear can't help you (again)

⚠️ Unstressed **-ance** and **-ence** are both pronounced /əns/ or /ns/. The difference is only on paper.

Word	IPA	Word	IPA
dist**ance**	/ˈdɪstəns/	exist**ence**	/ɪgˈzɪstəns/
guid**ance**	/ˈgaɪdns/	evid**ence**	/ˈevɪdəns/
perform**ance**	/pəˈfɔːməns/	refer**ence**	/ˈrefrəns/

When the ending is stressed, you *can* hear the a: adv**ance** /ədˈvɑːns/, enh**ance** /ɪnˈhɑːns/, rom**ance** /rəʊˈmæns/, fin**ance** /ˈfaɪnæns/. These are easy. The difficult ones are the unstressed endings.

The 5 rules

Rule 1: Follow the Day 1 family. The letter never changes inside a family.

- -**ant** → -**ance**: import**ant** → import**ance**, dist**ant** → dist**ance**, signific**ant** → signific**ance**
- -**ent** → -**ence**: differ**ent** → differ**ence**, confid**ent** → confid**ence**, independ**ent** → independ**ence**

Rule 2: Learn the -ence verb groups. Most other verbs take -ance.

Verb ends in…	Noun ends in	Examples
stressed **-er / -ur**	**-ence**	refe**r** → reference · prefe**r** → preference · confe**r** → conference · occ**ur** → occurrence
-ist	**-ence**	ex**ist** → existence · ins**ist** → insistence · pers**ist** → persistence ⚠️ *but* assist → assist**ance**, resist → resist**ance**
-ere	**-ence**	interf**ere** → interference · adh**ere** → adherence
-ide	**-ence**	res**ide** → residence · conf**ide** → confidence · coinc**ide** → coincidence ⚠️ *but* guide → guid**ance**
-ge (soft)	**-ence**	emer**ge** → emergence · conver**ge** → convergence
most other verbs	**-ance**	appear → appear**ance** · perform → perform**ance** · attend → attend**ance** · accept → accept**ance** · allow → allow**ance** · insure → insur**ance** · avoid → avoid**ance** · disturb → disturb**ance** · annoy → annoy**ance**

Rule 3: Hard c/g → -ance; soft c/g → -ence (same as Day 1).
signific**a**nce, ele**g**ance, extrava**g**ance (hard) · inno**c**ence, intelli**g**ence, ne**g**ligence, dili**g**ence (soft).

Rule 4: -iance comes only from verbs ending in -y.
var**y** → var**iance** · rel**y** → rel**iance** · appl**y** → appl**iance** · compl**y** → compl**iance** · all**y** → all**iance** · def**y** → def**iance**.

Every other "-ee-ens" ending is **-ience**: exper**ience** ★, conven**ience**, aud**ience**, sc**ience**, pat**ience**, obed**ience**.

Rule 5: Watch the spelling changes when you add the ending.

Verb	Noun	What changes
maint**ai**n	maint**en**ance	*ai* becomes *e*, and you add *-en-*
ent**er**	ent**r**ance	the *e* of *-er* goes
rememb**er**	rememb**r**ance	the *e* of *-er* goes
hind**er**	hind**r**ance	the *e* of *-er* goes
occ**ur**	occ**urr**ence	**double r** (stress stays on *-cur-*)
ref**er**	ref**e**rence	**single r** (stress moves to *RE-*)
pref**er**	pref**e**rence	**single r** (stress moves to *PRE-*)
exc**el**	exc**ell**ence	**double l**
obe**y**	obed**ience**	*y* becomes *-dience*

British English: -ce noun, -se verb

Noun (-ce)	Verb (-se)	Example
licen**ce**	licen**se**	You need a driving **licence**. The shop is **licensed** to sell food.
practi**ce**	practi**se**	I need more **practice**. I **practise** every day.
advi**ce** /ədˈvaɪs/	advi**se** /ədˈvaɪz/	Can you give me some **advice**? I **advise** you to book early.
defen**ce**, offen**ce**, preten**ce**	(*AmE: defense, offense, pretense*)	Use the **-ce** spelling throughout.

💡 **ICE is a noun, IS(E) is a verb.** *Advice* and *ice* are both nouns.

The IELTS sound-alike trap: -ance/-ence or -ants/-ents?

These pairs are pronounced **exactly the same**. Only the grammar tells you which to write.

Uncountable noun (a quality or idea)	Plural noun (people or things)	IPA (same for both)
patience: *Learning takes patience.*	**patients**: *The doctor sees 30 patients a day.*	/ˈpeɪʃns/
assistance: *Do you need assistance?*	**assistants**: *We need two shop assistants.*	/əˈsɪstəns/
presence: *Your presence is required.*	**presents**: *She opened her presents.*	/ˈprezns/
attendance: *Attendance is compulsory.*	**attendants**: *Flight attendants serve meals.*	/əˈtendəns/
residence: *a hall of residence*	**residents**: *Local residents complained.*	/ˈrezɪdəns/
innocence: *He proved his innocence.*	**innocents**: *Many innocents died.*	/ˈɪnəsns/

💡 **Grammar test:** after a **number, *many*, *several*, *a few*, *these*** or before **are/were** → plural **-ants/-ents**. After ***a lot of, some, need, show, require*** with a singular verb → **-ance/-ence**.

Word list A: -ANCE words (21)

Word · IPA · Part of speech	Meaning	Example sentence	❌ Common mistake
importance /ɪmˈpɔːtns/ *n*	the quality of being important	Don't forget the **importance** of sleep.	importence

Word · IPA · Part of speech	Meaning	Example sentence	❌ Common mistake
assistance /əˈsɪstəns/ *n*	help	Ask at the desk if you need **assistance**.	assistence
appearance /əˈpɪərəns/ *n*	the way something looks	The town has a modern **appearance**.	apperance, appearence
performance /pəˈfɔːməns/ *n*	a show; how well something works	The **performance** starts at 8 pm.	perfomance, performence
distance /ˈdɪstəns/ *n*	how far it is between two places	The **distance** to the station is 2 km.	distence
attendance /əˈtendəns/ *n*	being present; the number present	**Attendance** is checked every week.	attendence
acceptance /əkˈseptəns/ *n*	agreeing to take something	You'll get a letter of **acceptance**.	acceptence, exceptance
maintenance /ˈmeɪntənəns/ *n*	keeping something in good condition	Call **maintenance** about the leak.	maintainance, maintenence
resistance /rɪˈzɪstəns/ *n*	fighting against; not accepting	There was **resistance** to the plan.	resistence
guidance /ˈgaɪdns/ *n*	help and advice	Your tutor will give you **guidance**.	guidence, guidanse
insurance /ɪnˈʃʊərəns/ *n*	protection paid for against loss	Is **insurance** included in the price?	insurence, insurrance
entrance /ˈentrəns/ *n*	the way in	Meet at the main **entrance**.	enterance, entrence
allowance /əˈlaʊəns/ *n*	an amount allowed or given	The baggage **allowance** is 20 kg.	allowence, alowance
balance /ˈbæləns/ *n*	the money left in an account; steadiness	Check your account **balance**.	balence, ballance
relevance /ˈreləvəns/ *n*	connection to the subject	This has no **relevance** to the topic.	relevence
significance /sɪgˈnɪfɪkəns/ *n*	importance; meaning	The site has historical **significance**.	significence
tolerance /ˈtɒlərəns/ *n*	accepting differences or difficulty	Some plants have a high **tolerance** of heat.	tolerence
ambulance /ˈæmbjələns/ *n*	a vehicle for sick or injured people	Call an **ambulance**!	ambulence, ambulans
substance /ˈsʌbstəns/ *n*	a material or chemical	This **substance** is dangerous.	substence
abundance /əˈbʌndəns/ *n*	a large amount	There is an **abundance** of wildlife.	abundence
finance /ˈfaɪnæns/ *n, v*	money management	She works in **finance**.	finanse

Word list B: -ENCE words (21)

Word · IPA · Part of speech	Meaning	Example sentence	❌ Common mistake
difference /ˈdɪfrəns/ *n*	the way things are not the same	There's a big **difference** in price.	diffrence, differance
existence /ɪgˈzɪstəns/ *n*	the state of being real or alive	The club has been in **existence** for 50 years.	existance

Word · IPA · Part of speech	Meaning	Example sentence	❌ Common mistake
experience ★ /ɪkˈspɪəriəns/ *n, v*	knowledge from doing something	Do you have any sales **experience**?	experiance, experioence
confidence /ˈkɒnfɪdəns/ *n*	belief in yourself	She spoke with **confidence**.	confidance
evidence /ˈevɪdəns/ *n*	facts that prove something	There is no **evidence** of damage.	evidance
reference /ˈrefrəns/ *n*	a letter about you from a past employer; a source	Please supply two **references**.	refrence, referrence
preference /ˈprefrəns/ *n*	what you like better	Do you have a seat **preference**?	preferrence, prefrence
independence /ˌɪndɪˈpendəns/ *n*	freedom from control	Students value their **independence**.	independance
convenience /kənˈviːniəns/ *n*	being easy or useful	Online banking offers **convenience**.	convinience, conveniance
intelligence /ɪnˈtelɪdʒəns/ *n*	the ability to learn and think	Dolphins show great **intelligence**.	inteligence
excellence /ˈeksələns/ *n*	very high quality	The school has an award for **excellence**.	excellance, excelence
patience /ˈpeɪʃns/ *n*	staying calm while waiting	Thank you for your **patience**.	patients (= people)
conference /ˈkɒnfərəns/ *n*	a large formal meeting	The **conference** room is on floor 2.	conferance, confrence
occurrence /əˈkʌrəns/ *n*	something that happens	Floods are a common **occurrence**.	occurence, ocurrence
audience /ˈɔːdiəns/ *n*	people watching or listening	The **audience** clapped loudly.	audiance, odience
science /ˈsaɪəns/ *n*	study of the natural world	She teaches **science**.	sciance, sience
sentence ★ /ˈsentəns/ *n*	a group of words with a full meaning	Write one **sentence** for each word.	sentance, santance
residence /ˈrezɪdəns/ *n*	a home; where you live	First-years live in halls of **residence**.	residance
licence /ˈlaɪsns/ *n*	an official permit (BrE noun)	Bring your driving **licence**.	lisence, licance
consequence /ˈkɒnsɪkwəns/ *n*	a result	Pollution has serious **consequences**.	consequance
absence /ˈæbsəns/ *n*	not being present	Tell your tutor about any **absence**.	absance, abscence

-ancy and -ency: the same rule

Like *-ance* and *-ence*, the **-ancy / -ency** endings follow the family.

-ANCY	-ENCY
vac**ancy** (*a job vacancy*)	emerg**ency** (*emergency exit*)
accountancy (from *accountant*)	frequ**ency** (from *frequent*)
consult**ancy** (from *consultant*)	efficiency (from *efficient*)

-ANCY	-ENCY
pregn**ancy**	curr**ency** (*foreign currency*)
hesit**ancy** (from *hesitant*)	ag**ency** (*travel agency*)
const**ancy** (from *constant*)	flu**ency** (*IELTS: Fluency and Coherence*)
	proficI**ency** (*English proficiency*)
	consist**ency**, tend**ency**, urg**ency**

Common mistakes and corrections

❌ Wrong	✅ Right	Why
maintainance	**maintenance**	*ai* → *e*: MAIN + TEN + ANCE
occurence	**occurrence**	**cc** and **rr**: stress stays on *-cur-*
referrence	**reference**	single **r**: stress moves to *RE-*
existance	**existence**	exist → -ence (Rule 2)
independance	**independence**	still no *a* anywhere (Day 1)
attendence	**attendance**	attend a *dance*
apperance	**appearance**	appear + ance: keep *appear* whole
perfomance	**performance**	per + **form** + ance
enterance	**entrance**	enter loses its *e*
sentance ★	**sentence**	three *e*'s and no *a*
experiance ★	**experience**	-ience group (Rule 4), like *science*

Memory techniques

- 💡 **MAIN + TEN + ANCE.** The **main ten ants** do the **maintenance**.
- 💡 **atTEND a DANCE.** at + ten + **dance** = attendance.
- 💡 **perFORMance:** you fill in a **form** before a performance.
- 💡 **appEARance:** *appear* keeps its *ear*, then add *-ance*.
- 💡 **SCIENCE needs EXPERIENCE.** ★ Both end in *-ience*.
- 💡 **SENT-EN-CE.** ★ Three syllables, three *e*'s.
- 💡 **ocCURRence:** two **c**'s, two **r**'s. A *current* of two letters.
- 💡 **Is it a quality or a person?** Patience is a quality; patients are people.

Exercise 2.1: Complete each word with -ance or -ence

1. import_____
2. differ_____
3. appear_____
4. exist_____
5. perform_____
6. experi_____
7. attend_____
8. evid_____
9. accept_____
10. refer_____
11. mainten_____
12. prefer_____
13. guid_____
14. conveni_____

15. insur_____
16. intellig_____
17. resist_____
18. confer_____
19. dist_____
20. sent_____

Exercise 2.2: Word families

Write the noun.

1. important → _____
2. different → _____
3. confident → _____
4. independent → _____
5. resistant → _____
6. convenient → _____
7. excellent → _____
8. patient → _____
9. distant → _____
10. intelligent → _____
11. appear → _____
12. exist → _____
13. perform → _____
14. refer → _____
15. prefer → _____
16. maintain → _____
17. occur → _____
18. guide → _____
19. attend → _____
20. enter → _____

Exercise 2.3: Sound-alike pairs

Circle the correct word.

1. The doctor has 30 (**patience / patients**) to see today.
2. Learning a language takes a lot of (**patience / patients**).
3. We need two more shop (**assistance / assistants**) for the weekend.
4. Please ask at the desk if you need (**assistance / assistants**).
5. Your (**presence / presents**) is required at the meeting.
6. The children opened their (**presence / presents**).
7. (**Attendance / Attendants**) is checked at every lecture.
8. The flight (**attendance / attendants**) serve drinks after take-off.
9. First-year students live in a hall of (**residence / residents**).
10. Local (**residence / residents**) complained about the noise.

Exercise 2.4: Find and correct the spelling mistake

1. The maintainance fee is £20 a month. _____
2. Please bring two refrences. _____
3. Your experiance in sales is useful. _____
4. There is no evidance that it works. _____
5. The conferance starts at 9.30. _____
6. Class attendence is compulsory. _____
7. The performence starts at 8 pm. _____
8. The distence to the station is 2 km. _____
9. She speaks with great confidance. _____
10. Health insurence is included. _____

Exercise 2.5: Complete with -ancy or -ency

1. a job vac_____
2. an emerg_____ exit
3. radio frequ_____
4. energy effici_____
5. foreign curr_____
6. a travel ag_____
7. Fluency: flu_____
8. English profici_____
9. consist_____ in your work
10. a tend_____ to be late

Dictation 2

► Play **Day2_Dictation.wav**. Write each word once.

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____
6. _____
7. _____
8. _____
9. _____
10. _____
11. _____
12. _____
13. _____
14. _____
15. _____
16. _____
17. _____
18. _____
19. _____
20. _____

Day 2 Assessment (20 marks)

A. Circle the correct spelling. (10 marks)

1. a) maintenance b) maintainance c) maintenence
2. a) occurence b) occurrence c) ocurrence
3. a) existance b) existense c) existence
4. a) appearance b) apperance c) appearence
5. a) referrence b) reference c) refference
6. a) independance b) independence c) independents
7. a) attendence b) atendance c) attendance
8. a) experience b) experiance c) expirience
9. a) convenience b) conveniance c) convinience
10. a) guidence b) guidance c) guidanse

B. Write the -ance or -ence noun. (5 marks)

11. accept → _____
12. insure → _____
13. confer → _____
14. intelligent → _____

15. significant → _____

C. Write the correct word: patience / patients, assistance / assistants, presence / presents, licence / license, practice / practise. (5 marks)

16. The hospital has 200 beds and treats about 5,000 _____ a year.
17. You need a valid driving _____ to rent a car.
18. I need more _____ before the exam.
19. Two teaching _____ will help in the workshop.
20. Your _____ is not required at the second meeting.

My score: _____ / 20 · 18–20: well done, move on · 14–17: repeat Exercise 2.3 and the "-ence verb groups" table · below 14: repeat the dictation tomorrow

Day 3 -ABLE vs -IBLE

Learning objectives

By the end of today you will be able to:

- spell **42 common -able / -ible adjectives**;
- use the **"whole word" test** to choose the ending;
- add the ending correctly: drop the **-e** (*value* → *valuable* ★), keep the **-e** (*notice* → *noticeable*), change **y** → **i** (*rely* → *reliable*), or double the consonant (*forget* → *forgettable*);
- build nouns (**-ability / -ibility**), adverbs (**-ably / -ibly**) and opposites (**un-, in-, im-, il-, ir-**).

Pronunciation

⚠️ As a suffix, both **-able** and **-ible** are pronounced /əbl/: avail**able** /əˈveɪləbl/, poss**ible** /ˈpɒsəbl/. The word *able* on its own is /ˈeɪbl/, but you never hear that sound inside a longer word.

Some -able words also **lose a syllable in speech**, so you have to write letters you don't hear:

Word	You hear	You write
comfortable	/ˈkʌmf-tə-bl/ (3 syllables)	com-**for**-ta-ble (4 syllables)
reasonable	/ˈriːz-nə-bl/	rea-**so**-na-ble
valuable ★	/ˈvæl-jə-bl/	val-**u**-a-ble
vegetable	/ˈveʤ-tə-bl/	veg-**e**-ta-ble

💡 **Say it slowly in your head as it is *spelt*:** *com-FOR-ta-ble*, *veg-E-ta-ble*.

The 4 rules

Rule 1: The whole-word test (works about 80% of the time).
Cover the ending. If **a complete English word** is left, use **-able**. If what is left is **not a word**, use **-ible**.

Whole word → -ABLE	Not a word → -IBLE
comfortable, **reason**able	**poss**ible (*poss* ✗)
acceptable, **afford**able	**vis**ible (*vis* ✗)
enjoyable, **remark**able	**terr**ible, **horr**ible
understandable, **predict**able	**ed**ible, **aud**ible
sustainable, **renew**able	**feas**ible, **plaus**ible
dependable, **consider**able	**compat**ible, **tang**ible

⚠️ **Exceptions, whole word + -ible:** access → access**ible**, flex → flex**ible**, sense → sens**ible**, reverse → revers**ible**, convert → convert**ible**, response → respons**ible**, resist → resist**ible**, digest → digest**ible**.

⚠️ **Exceptions, not a word + -able:** cap**able**, prob**able**, dur**able**, vulner**able**, inevit**able**, vi**able**.

Rule 2: The noun test. If the related noun ends in **-ation**, use **-able**. If it ends in **-ion** without the *a* (**-sion, -ssion, -tion**), use **-ible**.

-ATION noun → -ABLE	-ION noun → -IBLE
tole**ration** → tolerable	vi**sion** → visible
applic**ation** → applicable	permi**ssion** → permissible
navig**ation** → navigable	divi**sion** → divisible
ador**ation** → adorable	comprehen**sion** → comprehensible
consider**ation** → considerable	conver**sion** → convertible
irrit**ation** → irritable	collec**tion** → collectible

Rule 3: Hard c/g → -able, soft c/g → -ible (the same idea as Days 1 and 2). appl**ic**able, navi**g**able, am**ic**able (hard) · eli**g**ible, le**g**ible, tan**g**ible, invin**c**ible, for**c**ible (soft).

⚠️ To keep a soft sound before *-able*, English **keeps the e**: noti**ce**able, mana**ge**able, chan**ge**able, knowled**ge**able, repla**ce**able.

Rule 4: When in doubt, choose -able.
There are about **five times more -able words**, and **all new words use -able**: download**able**, recycl**able**, do**able**, like**able**.

Spelling changes when you add -able / -ible

Change	Rule	Examples
Drop the silent e	base ends in *-e*	valu**e** → valuable ★ · lov**e** → lovable · us**e** → usable · believ**e** → believable · desir**e** → desirable · measur**e** → measurable · revers**e** → reversible · sens**e** → sensible
Keep the e	after soft **ce / ge**, and after **ee**	not**ice** → noticeable · manag**e** → manageable · chang**e** → changeable · knowledg**e** → knowledgeable · agr**ee** → agreeable
y → i	consonant + *y*	rel**y** → reliable · den**y** → deniable · var**y** → variable · justif**y** → justifiable · identif**y** → identifiable
Keep the y	vowel + *y*	enj**oy** → enjoyable · p**ay** → payable · empl**oy** → employable
Double the consonant	short stressed final syllable	forg**et** → forgettable · reg**ret** → regrettable · contr**ol** → controllable
⚠️ **Trap**	stress moves to the front	pref**er** → **pre**ferable (one *r*)

Word list A: -ABLE words (22)

Word · IPA · Part of speech	Meaning	Example sentence	❌ Common mistake
comfortable /ˈkʌmftəbl/ *adj*	pleasant to sit in or wear; relaxed	The seats are very **comfortable**.	comfortible, comftable
reasonable /ˈriːznəbl/ *adj*	fair; not too expensive	The rent is **reasonable**.	resonable, reasonible
understandable /ˌʌndəˈstændəbl/ *adj*	easy to understand; normal	His anger was **understandable**.	understandible
enjoyable /ɪnˈdʒɔɪəbl/ *adj*	giving pleasure	It was an **enjoyable** evening.	enjoyible, enjoible
reliable /rɪˈlaɪəbl/ *adj*	can be trusted	The bus service isn't **reliable**.	relyable, reliabel
valuable ★ /ˈvæljuəbl/ *adj*	worth a lot; very useful	Leave **valuable** items in the safe.	valueable, valuble

Word · IPA · Part of speech	Meaning	Example sentence	❌ Common mistake
remarkable /rɪˈmɑːkəbl/ *adj*	unusual and impressive	She made a **remarkable** recovery.	remarkible
suitable /ˈsuːtəbl/ *adj*	right for a purpose	This course is **suitable** for beginners.	suitible, sutable
available /əˈveɪləbl/ *adj*	free to use, buy or see	Rooms are **available** from June.	availible, avaliable
affordable /əˈfɔːdəbl/ *adj*	cheap enough to buy	We need **affordable** housing.	afordable, affordible
acceptable /əkˈseptəbl/ *adj*	good enough; allowed	Late work is not **acceptable**.	exceptable, acceptible
sustainable /səˈsteɪnəbl/ *adj*	able to continue without harming nature	We use **sustainable** materials.	sustainible, sustanable
renewable /rɪˈnjuːəbl/ *adj*	can be replaced naturally	Solar power is a **renewable** energy.	renewible, renuable
portable /ˈpɔːtəbl/ *adj*	easy to carry	Bring a **portable** charger.	portible
noticeable /ˈnəʊtɪsəbl/ *adj*	easy to see	There's a **noticeable** difference.	noticable
manageable /ˈmænɪdʒəbl/ *adj*	possible to deal with	The workload is **manageable**.	managable
knowledgeable /ˈnɒlɪdʒəbl/ *adj*	knowing a lot	The guide was very **knowledgeable**.	knowledgable, knowlegable
applicable /əˈplɪkəbl/ *adj*	relevant to a person or case	Write "N/A" (*not applicable*).	applicible
capable /ˈkeɪpəbl/ *adj*	having the ability	She is **capable** of running the shop.	capible
vulnerable /ˈvʌlnərəbl/ *adj*	easily hurt or damaged	Old people are more **vulnerable** to flu.	vulnerible, vulnarable
inevitable /ɪnˈevɪtəbl/ *adj*	certain to happen	Some delay is **inevitable**.	inevitible, inavitable
considerable /kənˈsɪdərəbl/ *adj*	large in size or amount	It costs a **considerable** amount.	considerible

Word list B: -IBLE words (20)

Word · IPA · Part of speech	Meaning	Example sentence	❌ Common mistake
possible /ˈpɒsəbl/ *adj*	can happen or be done	Is it **possible** to pay by card?	possable, posible
responsible /rɪˈspɒnsəbl/ *adj*	having a duty; being the cause	Who is **responsible** for the keys?	responsable, resposible
accessible /əkˈsesəbl/ *adj*	easy to reach or enter	The museum is **accessible** by wheelchair.	accesible, accessable
flexible /ˈfleksəbl/ *adj*	can change easily	The hours are **flexible**.	flexable, flexibel
visible /ˈvɪzəbl/ *adj*	can be seen	The castle is **visible** from the road.	visable
eligible /ˈelɪdʒəbl/ *adj*	allowed by the rules	Only residents are **eligible**.	eligable, eligeble
incredible /ɪnˈkredəbl/ *adj*	amazing; hard to believe	The view was **incredible**.	incredable

Word · IPA · Part of speech	Meaning	Example sentence	❌ Common mistake
sensible /ˈsensəbl/ *adj*	practical and wise	Wear **sensible** shoes.	sensable
reversible /rɪˈvɜːsəbl/ *adj*	can be changed back	The damage is not **reversible**.	reversable
compatible /kəmˈpætəbl/ *adj*	able to work together	Is it **compatible** with my phone?	compatable
legible /ˈledʒəbl/ *adj*	clear enough to read	Make sure your writing is **legible**.	legable
terrible /ˈterəbl/ *adj*	very bad	The traffic was **terrible**.	terrable, terible
horrible /ˈhɒrəbl/ *adj*	very unpleasant	The weather was **horrible**.	horrable, horible
edible /ˈedəbl/ *adj*	safe to eat	Are these mushrooms **edible**?	edable
audible /ˈɔːdəbl/ *adj*	can be heard	His voice was barely **audible**.	audable
feasible /ˈfiːzəbl/ *adj*	possible and practical	The plan is not **feasible**.	feasable, fesible
plausible /ˈplɔːzəbl/ *adj*	seeming reasonable or true	That's a **plausible** explanation.	plausable
tangible /ˈtændʒəbl/ *adj*	real; can be touched	We need **tangible** results.	tangable
convertible /kənˈvɜːtəbl/ *adj, n*	can be changed; a car with a soft roof	The sofa is **convertible** into a bed.	convertable
permissible /pəˈmɪsəbl/ *adj*	allowed	Mobile phones are not **permissible** here.	permissable

Word families: nouns, adverbs and opposites

The letter (**a** or **i**) stays the same in the whole family.

Adjective	Noun (-ity)	Adverb (-ly)	Opposite
available	avail**ability**	—	**un**available
reliable	reli**ability**	reli**ably**	**un**reliable
suitable	suit**ability**	suit**ably**	**un**suitable
sustainable	sustain**ability**	sustain**ably**	**un**sustainable
accountable	accountability ★	—	**un**accountable
comfortable	—	comfort**ably**	**un**comfortable
acceptable	accept**ability**	accept**ably**	**un**acceptable
capable	cap**ability**	cap**ably**	**in**capable
responsible	responsibility ★	respons**ibly**	**ir**responsible
possible	poss**ibility**	poss**ibly**	**im**possible
flexible	flex**ibility**	flex**ibly**	**in**flexible
accessible	access**ibility**	—	**in**accessible
visible	vis**ibility**	vis**ibly**	**in**visible
eligible	elig**ibility**	—	**in**eligible
legible	leg**ibility**	leg**ibly**	**il**legible
reversible	—	—	**ir**reversible

Adjective	Noun (-ity)	Adverb (-ly)	Opposite
compatible	compat**ibility**	—	**in**compatible

⚠️ **Prefixes can make double letters: il** + legible = i**ll**egible · **ir** + responsible = i**rr**esponsible · **ir** + reversible = i**rr**eversible · **im** + mature = i**mm**ature. Use **il-** before *l*, **ir-** before *r*, and **im-** before *p, b, m*.

Common mistakes and corrections

❌ Wrong	✅ Right	Why
availible	**available**	*avail* is a word → -able
responsable	**responsible**	respons(e) + ible: exception to Rule 1
reposibility ★	**responsibility**	re + **spons** + ibility (*response* is inside)
accesible	**accessible**	double *c*, double *s*
valueable ★	**valuable**	drop the *e* of *value*
noticable	**noticeable**	keep the *e* to keep the *c* soft
knowledgable	**knowledgeable**	keep the *e*: knowledge + able
relyable	**reliable**	*y* → *i*
comfortible	**comfortable**	*comfort* is a word → -able
eligable	**eligible**	soft *g* → -ible
iresponsible	**irresponsible**	ir + responsible = **rr**

Memory techniques

- 💡 **Can it stand alone?** *Comfort, accept, afford, enjoy* can stand alone → **-able**. *Poss-, vis-, terr-* can't → **-ible**.
- 💡 **Soft E Keeps it Easy:** notic**e**able, manag**e**able. The *e* protects the soft sound.
- 💡 **valu-able ★**: the *e* in *value* goes before a vowel suffix.
- 💡 **re-SPONSE-ible:** *responsible* and *responsibility* ★ both contain *respons(e)*.
- 💡 **No clue? Choose -able.** It's five times more common.
- 💡 **ACCESSIBLE: two c's for the two Cars at the entrance, two s's for the two Steps.**

Exercise 3.1: Complete each word with -able or -ible

1. comfort_____
2. reason_____
3. avail_____
4. poss_____
5. respons_____
6. access_____
7. flex_____
8. vis_____
9. reli_____
10. suit_____
11. elig_____
12. incred_____
13. sens_____
14. valu_____
15. enjoy_____
16. compat_____
17. afford_____
18. leg_____
19. ed_____
20. sustain_____

Exercise 3.2: Add -able (watch the spelling change)

1. value → _____
2. rely → _____
3. notice → _____
4. manage → _____
5. forget → _____
6. believe → _____
7. change → _____
8. regret → _____
9. use → _____
10. knowledge → _____
11. desire → _____
12. vary → _____

Exercise 3.3: Write the noun (-ability / -ibility)

1. available → _____
2. responsible → _____
3. flexible → _____
4. possible → _____
5. reliable → _____
6. accessible → _____
7. sustainable → _____
8. eligible → _____
9. visible → _____
10. accountable → _____

Exercise 3.4: Write the opposite

1. possible → _____
2. responsible → _____
3. legible → _____
4. visible → _____
5. reliable → _____
6. comfortable → _____
7. acceptable → _____
8. flexible → _____
9. eligible → _____
10. reversible → _____

Exercise 3.5: Find and correct the spelling mistake

1. The room is availible from June. _____
2. Parents are responsable for their children's safety. _____
3. The museum is easily accesible by bus. _____
4. The working hours are very flexable. _____
5. My old car was very relyable. _____
6. The price seems resonable. _____
7. Only full-time students are eligable. _____
8. These seats are not very comfortible. _____
9. The ring is very valueable. _____
10. His handwriting was not legable. _____

Dictation 3

► Play **Day3_Dictation.wav**. Write each word once.

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____
6. _____
7. _____
8. _____
9. _____
10. _____
11. _____
12. _____
13. _____
14. _____
15. _____
16. _____
17. _____
18. _____
19. _____
20. _____

Day 3 Assessment (20 marks)

A. Circle the correct spelling. (10 marks)

1. a) availible b) available c) avaliable
2. a) responsible b) responsable c) resposible
3. a) accesible b) accessable c) accessible
4. a) noticable b) noticeable c) noticible
5. a) reliable b) relyable c) reliabel
6. a) flexable b) flexibel c) flexible
7. a) knowledgable b) knowledgeable c) knowlegeable
8. a) suitible b) suitable c) sutable
9. a) eligible b) eligable c) eligeble
10. a) valueable b) valuble c) valuable

B. Add -able or -ible and write the whole word. (5 marks)

11. sustain → _____
12. manage → _____
13. sense → _____
14. forget → _____
15. compat- → _____

C. Write the opposite. (5 marks)

16. possible → _____
17. responsible → _____
18. legible → _____
19. accessible → _____
20. available → _____

My score: _____ / 20 · 18–20: well done, move on · 14–17: repeat the "Spelling changes" table and Exercise 3.2 · below 14: repeat the dictation tomorrow

Day 4 -ARY vs -ERY and Other Confusing Endings

Learning objectives

By the end of today you will be able to:

- spell **40 common -ary / -ery words**, plus the **-ory** and **-ry** words that sound the same;
- tell **stationary** from **stationery**, and **diary** from **dairy**;
- use **9 mini-lessons** on other endings that cost marks in IELTS: **-tion/-sion · -al/-el/-le · -ic/-ical · -cial/-tial · -ous/-ious · -ful/-fully · -or/-our/-er/-ar · -er/-re · -ise/-ize**.

💡 **How to study today:** Part A is the main lesson. Treat Part B as 9 short lessons of about 5 minutes each. Read the rule, say the examples aloud, and then do the matching exercise.

Part A: -ARY vs -ERY (vs -ORY and -RY)

Why your ear can't help you

All four endings are reduced to /əri/ or just /ri/. In British English, the vowel often **disappears completely**:

Word	IPA	Syllables you hear	Syllables you write
secretary	/ˈsekrətri/	3	sec-re-ta-ry (4)
dictionary	/ˈdɪkʃənri/	3	dic-tion-a-ry (4)
laboratory	/ləˈbɒrətri/	4	lab-or-a-to-ry (5)
stationery	/ˈsteɪʃənri/	3	sta-tion-e-ry (4)
library	/ˈlaɪbrəri/ or /ˈlaɪbri/	2–3	li-bra-ry (3)

The 4 rules

Rule 1: -ary is the most common ending. Most adjectives (*necessary, ordinary, temporary, primary, voluntary*) and many nouns (*library, dictionary, salary, summary*) end in **-ary**. If you have no other clue, choose **-ary**.

Rule 2: -ery = a whole word + -(e)ry. If you can see a complete word you know, it's usually **-ery**.

Base word	-ERY word	Base word	-ERY word
bake	bak**ery**	deliver	deliver**y**
brew	brew**ery**	discover	discover**y**
machine	machin**ery**	recover	recover**y**
scene	scen**ery**	cook	cook**ery**
green	green**ery**	nurse	nurs**ery**
brave	brav**ery**	pot	pott**ery**
rob	robb**ery**	jewel	jewell**ery** (BrE)

⚠️ **Learn these as a group:** gall**ery**, batt**ery**, myst**ery**, surg**ery**, cemet**ery** (3 e's), lott**ery**, celery. They have no base word.

Rule 3: -ory usually has a related word with -or, -ion or -ive.
direct**or** → direct**ory** · access → access**ory** · satisfact**ion** → satisfact**ory** · compuls**ion** → compuls**ory** · observat**ion**

→ observat**ory** · invent**ion** → invent**ory**. Also learn: fact**ory**, hist**ory**, laborat**ory**, dormit**ory**, categ**ory**, territ**ory**, mem**ory**, the**ory**.

Rule 4: -ry with no vowel. If the base word ends in *-er* or *-t*, the vowel often disappears: ent**er** → **entry** ★, chemist → **chemistry**, poet → **poetry**, regist**er** → **registry**, minist**er** → **ministry**. Also **country**, **industry**, **pastry**.

The two IELTS traps

Word	Meaning	Memory trick
stationery /ˈsteɪʃənri/ *n*	paper, pens, envelopes	**e** for **e**nvelopes
stationary /ˈsteɪʃənri/ *adj*	not moving	**a** for **a**t rest; a c**ar** p**ar**ked
diary /ˈdaɪəri/ *n*	a book for daily notes	**I** write in my d**i**ary (i before a)
dairy /ˈdeəri/ *n*	milk products; a milk farm	**ai**r: a cow breathes fresh **ai**r in a d**ai**ry

Word list A: -ARY words (20)

Word · IPA · Part of speech	Meaning	Example sentence	❌ Common mistake
necessary /ˈnesəsəri/ *adj*	needed	It isn't **necessary** to book.	neccessary, necesary
ordinary /ˈɔːdnri/ *adj*	normal, not special	It was an **ordinary** day.	ordinery, ordanary
temporary /ˈtemprəri/ *adj*	lasting a short time	She has a **temporary** job.	temporery, tempory
vocabulary /vəˈkæbjələri/ *n*	the words of a language	Learn new **vocabulary** daily.	vocabulery, vocabulry
library /ˈlaɪbrəri/ *n*	a place to borrow books	The **library** closes at 9 pm.	libary, librery
anniversary /ˌænɪˈvɜːsəri/ *n*	the same date as a past event	It's the museum's 50th **anniversary**.	anniversery, aniversary
secretary /ˈsekrətri/ *n*	an office assistant; a club official	Leave a message with the **secretary**.	secretery, secratary
dictionary /ˈdɪkʃənri/ *n*	a book of words and meanings	Check the **dictionary**.	dictionery, dictionnary
primary /ˈpraɪməri/ *adj*	first; main	She teaches at a **primary** school.	primery
secondary /ˈsekəndri/ *adj*	second; for ages 11–18	**Secondary** school starts at 11.	secondery
salary /ˈsæləri/ *n*	fixed pay for a job	The **salary** is £25,000 a year.	salery, sallary
summary /ˈsʌməri/ *n*	a short version	Write a **summary** of the talk.	summery (= like summer), sumary
boundary /ˈbaʊndri/ *n*	a line that marks a limit	The river is the **boundary**.	boundery, boundry
documentary /ˌdɒkjuˈmentri/ *n*	a factual film	We watched a **documentary** about bees.	documentery, documantary
voluntary /ˈvɒləntri/ *adj*	done without pay or by choice	The work is **voluntary**.	voluntery, volentary
itinerary /aɪˈtɪnərəri/ *n*	a plan of a journey	Here is your travel **itinerary**.	itinery, itenerary
contemporary /kənˈtemprəri/ *adj*	modern; of the same time	It's a gallery of **contemporary** art.	contemporery, contempory
diary /ˈdaɪəri/ *n*	a book for daily notes	Write it in your **diary**.	dairy (= milk products)
dairy /ˈdeəri/ *n, adj*	milk products	I don't eat **dairy** products.	diary
military /ˈmɪlətri/ *adj*	relating to the army	It's an old **military** base.	militery, millitary

Word list B: -ERY words (20)

Word · IPA · Part of speech	Meaning	Example sentence	❌ Common mistake
stationery /ˈsteɪʃənri/ *n*	paper, pens and envelopes	The shop sells **stationery**.	stationary (= not moving)
machinery /məˈʃiːnəri/ *n*	machines as a group	Farm **machinery** is expensive.	machinary, mashinery
delivery /dɪˈlɪvəri/ *n*	bringing goods to a place	**Delivery** is free.	delivary, delivry
discovery /dɪˈskʌvəri/ *n*	finding something new	It was an important **discovery**.	discovary
recovery /rɪˈkʌvəri/ *n*	getting better	He made a full **recovery**.	recovary
bakery /ˈbeɪkəri/ *n*	a shop that makes bread	The **bakery** opens at 7.	bakary
gallery /ˈgæləri/ *n*	a place to show art	The **gallery** is free to enter.	galary, gallary
battery /ˈbætri/ *n*	a store of electric power	The **battery** is low.	batery, battary
mystery /ˈmɪstri/ *n*	something not understood	The cause is still a **mystery**.	mistery, mystary
nursery /ˈnɜːsəri/ *n*	a place for young children; for plants	My son goes to **nursery**.	nursary
scenery /ˈsiːnəri/ *n*	natural views	The **scenery** is beautiful.	scenary, seenery
surgery /ˈsɜːdʒəri/ *n*	an operation; a doctor's office (BrE)	The **surgery** opens at 8.30.	surgary, sergery
pottery /ˈpɒtəri/ *n*	pots made from clay	She does a **pottery** class.	potery, pottary
jewellery /ˈdʒuːəlri/ *n*	rings, necklaces etc. (BrE)	The **jewellery** is in the safe.	jewelery, jewllery
cemetery /ˈsemətri/ *n*	a place where people are buried	There's an old **cemetery** by the church.	cemetary, cematery
brewery /ˈbruːəri/ *n*	a place that makes beer	The tour visits a **brewery**.	brewary
lottery /ˈlɒtəri/ *n*	a game where tickets win prizes	He won the **lottery**.	lottary, lotery
cookery /ˈkʊkəri/ *n*	cooking as a skill	I'm taking a **cookery** course.	cookary
greenery /ˈgriːnəri/ *n*	green plants	The room needs more **greenery**.	greenary
bravery /ˈbreɪvəri/ *n*	courage	She won an award for **bravery**.	bravary

Also learn (-ory, -ry): factory · history · laboratory /ləˈbɒrətri/ · dormitory · category · compulsory /kəmˈpʌlsəri/ · satisfactory · directory · accessory · observatory · inventory · territory · **entry** ★ · country · industry · chemistry · poetry · registry · ministry · pastry

Part B: Nine more confusing endings

B1. -tion vs -sion vs -ssion vs -cian

All of these are pronounced /ʃən/ or /ʒən/, and the /ʒən/ sound is the only one that tells you the letter.

Rule	Examples
You hear **/ʒən/** (as in *vision*) → always **-sion**	deci**sion**, televi**sion**, revi**sion**, conclu**sion** ★, confu**sion**, occa**sion**, divi**sion**, ero**sion**, inva**sion**
Verb ends in **-d / -de / -se** → **-sion**	deci**de** → decision · conclu**de** → conclusion · exten**d** → extension · expan**d** → expansion · inclu**de** → inclusion · revi**se** → revision

Rule	Examples
Verb ends in **-mit** → **-mission**	ad**mit** → admission · per**mit** → permission · sub**mit** → submission · trans**mit** → transmission
Verb ends in **-ss** → **-ssion**	discu**ss** → discussion · expre**ss** → expression · impre**ss** → impression · profe**ss** → profession · posse**ss** → possession
Everything else → **-tion** (most common)	educa**te** → education · inform → information · regist**er** → registration · reser**ve** → reservation · pollu**te** → pollution · introdu**ce** → introduction · prescri**be** → prescription · solve → solution · compete → competition
⚠️ Exceptions with -d	attend → atten**tion** · intend → inten**tion**
-cian = a person with a skill	musi**cian**, electri**cian**, techni**cian**, politi**cian**, opti**cian**, physi**cian**, mathemati**cian** (from *music, electric, technic(al), politics, optics*)
-stion = /stʃən/	que**stion**, sugge**stion**, dige**stion**, exhau**stion**

⚠️ **British spelling:** cancel → can**cell**ation (double *l*); pronounce → pron**u**nciation (no *o* after *n*).

B2. -al vs -el vs -le

Ending	When	Examples
-al	Most **adjectives**; nouns made from verbs; many common nouns	loc**al**, natur**al**, fin**al**, norm**al**, centr**al**, rur**al**, glob**al**, annu**al**, practic**al** ★, physic**al** ★, cultur**al** ★ · arriv**al**, approv**al**, propos**al**, surviv**al**, rent**al**, refus**al** · hospit**al**, anim**al**, mamm**al** ★, festiv**al**, sign**al**, met**al**, capit**al**, journ**al**, termin**al**, interv**al**
-el	Mostly **nouns**, especially after **m, n, r, v, w, ch, sh** and a soft **c / g**	cam**el**, tunn**el**, chann**el**, pan**el**, barr**el**, nov**el**, lev**el**, trav**el**, tow**el**, vow**el**, jew**el**, parc**el**, canc**el**, ang**el** · also hot**el**, mod**el**, lab**el**, host**el**, fu**el**, vess**el**, personn**el**
-le	The **most common** ending of all, especially after **b, d, k, p, t, g, z, f**	tab**le**, peop**le**, vehic**le**, artic**le**, bicyc**le**, circ**le**, tit**le**, middl**e**, simp**le**, samp**le**, exam**ple**, sing**le**, doub**le**, coup**le**, bott**le**, puzz**le**, cab**le**, cast**le**

⚠️ **Sound-alike pairs:** angle (90°) / angel (in heaven) · metal (iron) / medal (a prize) · principal (head of a school; main) / principle (a rule) · council (the local government) / counsel (advice) · moral (right and wrong) / morale (team spirit).

B3. -ic vs -ical

Rule	Examples
Some words have **-ic only**	academic, scientific, specific, basic, public, dramatic, realistic, athletic, domestic, fantastic, democratic, energetic
Some words have **-ical only**	practical ★, physical ★, chemical, medical, musical, typical, logical, critical, technical, biological, geographical, tropical, identical
Both forms, different meanings	**economic** (about the economy: *economic growth*) / **economical** (cheap to use: *an economical car*) · **historic** (very important in history: *a historic day*) / **historical** (about the past: *historical records*) · **electric** (powered by electricity: *an electric car*) / **electrical** (about electricity: *an electrical engineer*) · **classic** (excellent, typical: *a classic film*) / **classical** (traditional: *classical music*)
Adverbs: -ic + **ally**	basic → basic**ally** · specific → specific**ally** · scientific → scientific**ally** · dramatic → dramatic**ally** · automatic → automatic**ally**

⚠️ **The adverb ending -ically is pronounced /ɪkli/, so the *al* is silent.** Don't write *basicly*. The **only** exception is **publicly**.

B4. -cial vs -tial

Both are pronounced /ʃl/. **Look at the base word.**

Base word ends in...	Ending	Examples
-ence, or **-t**	**-tial**	ess**ence** → essential · resid**ence** → residential · confid**ence** → confidential · influ**ence** → influential · sequ**ence** → sequential · par**t** → partial · president → presidential · poten(cy) → potential
-ce (not -ence)	**-cial**	finan**ce** → financial · offi**ce** → official · commer**ce** → commercial · ra**ce** → racial · fa**ce** → facial · provin**ce** → provincial · benefi**t** → beneficial ⚠️
No base word (learn them)	—	spe**cial**, so**cial**, cru**cial** · ini**tial**, spa**tial**

⚠️ **Exceptions:** substance → substan**tial**, circumstance → circumstan**tial**, benefit → benefi**cial**.

B5. -ous vs -ious vs -eous vs -uous

Rule	Examples
-ous is the default; **drop the e** of the base word	fam**e** → famous ★ · nerv**e** → nervous ★ · adventur**e** → adventurous · plus danger**ous**, enorm**ous**, gener**ous**, numer**ous**, poison**ous**, mountain**ous**
Base word ends in **consonant + y** → **y becomes i** → **-ious**	var**y** → various · fur**y** → furious · glor**y** → glorious · myster**y** → mysterious · luxur**y** → luxurious · industr**y** → industrious · harmon**y** → harmonious · env**y** → envious
You hear **/ʃəs/** → **-cious, -tious, -xious** (and *-scious*)	deli**cious**, spa**cious**, pre**cious**, suspi**cious** · ambi**tious**, cau**tious**, nutri**tious** · an**xious** · con**scious** ★
You hear **/iəs/** with no base word → **-ious**	pre**vious**, obv**ious**, ser**ious**, cur**ious**, var**ious**
Keep the e after soft **g** → **-eous**	courag**e** → courageous · outrag**e** → outrageous · advantag**e** → advantageous · also gorg**eous**, spontan**eous**, simultan**eous**
-uous after the /ju/ sound	contin**uous**, ambig**uous**, strenu**ous**

B6. -ful vs -fully

Rule	Examples
The suffix **-ful has ONE l**	care**ful**, use**ful**, help**ful**, success**ful** ★, harm**ful**, peace**ful**, stress**ful**, power**ful**, colour**ful**, thank**ful**
-ful + ly = -fully (now two l's)	care**fully**, success**fully**, beauti**fully**, hope**fully**, grate**fully**
y → i before -ful	beaut**y** → beautiful · pit**y** → pitiful · plent**y** → plentiful
⚠️ British single l	skil**ful**, wil**ful**, fulfil, fulfilment, enrol, enrolment, instalment (AmE: skillful, fulfill, enroll)
⚠️ *great ≠ grate*	**grate**ful (not *greatful*) · **aw**ful (from *awe*, the e goes)
Plurals of -ful nouns	spoon**fuls**, cup**fuls**, hand**fuls**, mouth**fuls** (not *spoonsful*)

B7. -or vs -our vs -er vs -ar

Ending	When	Examples
-our (BrE)	Common nouns of feeling or quality	colour, behaviour, neighbour, favour, favourite ★, flavour, honour, humour, labour, harbour, rumour, vapour, endeavour

Ending	When	Examples
⚠️ **-our loses the u** before *-ous, -ary, -ation, -ise*		hum**or**ous, glam**or**ous, lab**or**ious, hon**or**ary, vap**or**ise (but **keeps** it in col**our**ful, fav**our**ite, hon**our**able, behavi**our**al)
-or for people	verb ends in **-ate, -ct, -ss, -it**	operat**e** → operator · translat**e** → translator · administrat**e** → administrator · coordinat**e** → coordinator · dire**ct** → director · instru**ct** → instructor · condu**ct** → conductor · inspe**ct** → inspector · profe**ss** → professor · vis**it** → visitor · ed**it** → editor · plus doctor, author, tutor, sailor, supervisor, counsellor
-er for people	most everyday verbs	teach**er**, manag**er**, employ**er**, research**er**, design**er**, photograph**er**, build**er**, own**er**, speak**er**, lectur**er**
-ar	learn these (many are IELTS words)	semin**ar**, calend**ar**, gramm**ar** ★, simil**ar** ★, popul**ar**, regul**ar**, particul**ar**, famili**ar**, circul**ar**, sol**ar**, lun**ar**, pol**ar**, coll**ar**, cell**ar**, doll**ar**, pill**ar**, sug**ar**, guit**ar** ★, schol**ar**, regist**rar**, burgl**ar**, li**ar**, begg**ar**

B8. -er vs -re (British English)

Ending	Examples
-re (BrE)	**centre** (*city centre, sports centre, leisure centre, shopping centre*), **theatre**, **metre** (a measurement: *5 metres*), **litre**, **kilometre**, **fibre**, **sombre**, **manoeuvre**; also **acre**, **massacre**, **mediocre** (all spellings)
-er (all spellings)	water, letter, number, winter, computer, register, character, chapter, filter, order, offer, poster, member, minister, disaster, quarter, cylinder, river
⚠️ **meter vs metre**	a **meter** measures something (*gas meter, parking meter*); a **metre** is 100 cm
Words made from -re	centre → **central** · theatre → **theatrical** · metre → **metric** · fibre → **fibrous** (the *e* moves or goes)

B9. -ise vs -ize (and -yse)

Rule	Examples
British English accepts **both -ise and -ize** for most verbs. **Choose -ise** and use it always.	organise, realise, recognise, apologise, criticise, emphasise, specialise, minimise, prioritise, summarise, memorise, socialise, modernise
Always -ise (in both British and American English)	advertise, advise, arise, compromise, comprise, devise, disguise, enterprise, exercise ★, franchise, improvise, revise, supervise, surprise, televise
Always -ize (in both)	size, prize (*an award*), capsize, and **seize** (with *ei*)
Always -yse in British English	analyse, paralyse, catalyse (AmE: analyze)

Common mistakes and corrections

❌ Wrong	✅ Right	Why
neccessary	**necessary**	one **c**, two **s** (one Collar, two Sleeves)
stationary (*for pens*)	**stationery**	**e** for **e**nvelopes
libary	**library**	li-**br**-ary: two *r*'s
temporery	**temporary**	adjective → -ary
cemetary	**cemetery**	three *e*'s: c-**e**-m-**e**-t-**e**-ry
entre ★	**entry**	enter → entry (Rule 4)

❌ Wrong	✅ Right	Why
conculation ★	**conclusion**	concl**ude** → concl**usion** (B1)
practicial ★	**practical**	-ical only, no extra *i* (B3)
basicly	**basically**	-ic + **ally** (B3)
beautyful	**beautiful**	*y* → *i* (B6)
successfull ★	**successful**	-ful has one *l* (B6)
grammer ★ / similer ★ / guiter ★	**grammar / similar / guitar**	the -ar group (B7)
favourate ★	**favourite**	favour + **ite** (B7)
famouse / femous ★	**famous**	fam**e** → famous: drop the *e*, keep the *a* (B5)
excercise ★	**exercise**	no *c* after the *x*; always **-ise** (B9)

Memory techniques

- 💡 **neCeSSary:** one **C**ollar and two **S**leeves.
- 💡 **stationEry has Envelopes**; **stationAry is At rest**.
- 💡 **A cEmEtEry has three Es**, like three gravestones.
- 💡 **-ary is the default, -ery needs a base word** (bake → bakery).
- 💡 **Hear /ʒən/? Write -sion.** *Vision, decision, television.*
- 💡 **"Basically" has an ALLY:** basic + **ally**.
- 💡 **-ful is never full:** only one *l*.
- 💡 **A seminAR in the cAR, a guitAR at the bAR:** the -ar words.
- 💡 **British -re: centre, theatre, metre.** The **R** comes before the **E**, as in **Royal English**.

Exercise 4.1: Complete with -ary, -ery, -ory or -ry

1. necess_____
2. ordin_____
3. tempor_____
4. vocabul_____
5. libr_____
6. station_____ (*pens, paper*)
7. machin_____
8. deliv_____
9. discov_____
10. recov_____
11. annivers_____
12. secret_____
13. diction_____
14. bak_____
15. gall_____
16. batt_____
17. fact_____
18. hist_____
19. laborat_____
20. ent_____ (*the way in; a competition form*)

Exercise 4.2: Circle the correct word

1. The train was (**stationary / stationery**) for twenty minutes.
2. Envelopes and pens are in the (**stationary / stationery**) cupboard.
3. I wrote the date in my (**diary / dairy**).
4. Milk and cheese are (**diary / dairy**) products.
5. The pool is 25 (**metres / meters**) long.

6. Read the gas (**metre / meter**) once a month.
7. What's on the TV (**programme / program**) tonight?
8. The computer (**programme / program**) crashed again. *(British English uses the shorter spelling for software.)*

Exercise 4.3: Complete with -tion, -sion, -ssion or -cian

1. deci_____
2. informa_____
3. conclu_____
4. discu_____
5. registra_____
6. permi_____
7. electri_____
8. televi_____
9. accommoda_____
10. expre_____
11. techni_____
12. exten_____
13. prescrip_____
14. occa_____

Exercise 4.4: Complete with -al, -el or -le

1. hot_____
2. trav_____
3. loc_____
4. nov_____ (*a book*)
5. lev_____
6. natur_____
7. mamm_____
8. tunn_____
9. arriv_____
10. chann_____
11. festiv_____
12. parc_____
13. vehic_____
14. artic_____

Exercise 4.5: -cial / -tial and -ic / -ical

A. Complete with -cial or -tial.

1. spe_____
2. so_____
3. offi_____
4. finan_____
5. essen_____
6. poten_____
7. residen_____
8. confiden_____

B. Circle the correct word.

9. This car is very (**economic / economical**): it uses little fuel.
10. The country's (**economic / economical**) growth was 3% last year.
11. 4 July 1776 was a (**historic / historical**) day.
12. I love (**classic / classical**) music, especially Mozart.

Exercise 4.6: Complete with -ous, -ious, -eous or -uous

1. fam_____
2. nerv_____
3. danger_____
4. var_____
5. prev_____
6. obv_____

7. anx_____
8. ser_____
9. delic_____
10. consc_____
11. gorg_____
12. courag_____
13. enorm_____
14. contin_____

Exercise 4.7: Complete with -or, -our, -er or -ar

1. col_____
2. behavi_____
3. neighb_____
4. doct_____
5. visit_____
6. direct_____
7. manag_____
8. semin_____
9. calend_____
10. gramm_____
11. guit_____
12. instruct_____

Exercise 4.8: Mixed endings

1. the city cent_____
2. a gas met_____ (*device*)
3. five kilomet_____
4. the theat_____
5. regist_____ (*v*)
6. analy_____e the data
7. advert_____se a job
8. exerci_____e
9. care + ful + ly → _____
10. skill + ful (BrE) → _____
11. success + ful → _____
12. beauty + ful → _____

Dictation 4

► Play **Day4_Dictation.wav**. Write each word once.

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____
6. _____
7. _____
8. _____
9. _____
10. _____
11. _____
12. _____
13. _____
14. _____
15. _____
16. _____
17. _____
18. _____
19. _____
20. _____

Day 4 Assessment (20 marks)

A. Circle the correct spelling. (10 marks)

1. a) neccessary b) necesary c) necessary
2. a) stationery b) stationary c) stationerry *(pens and paper)*
3. a) labratory b) laboratory c) laboratary
4. a) secretery b) secratary c) secretary
5. a) delivery b) delivary c) delivry
6. a) temporery b) temporary c) tempory
7. a) anniversery b) aniversary c) anniversary
8. a) dictionary b) dictionery c) dictionnary
9. a) cemetary b) cemetery c) cematery
10. a) vocabulery b) vocabulary c) vocabulairy

B. Complete the ending. (5 marks)

11. conclu_____
12. electri_____ (*a person*)
13. mamm_____
14. deli_____ (*tastes very good*)
15. behavi_____

C. Correct the spelling. (5 marks)

16. seminer _____
17. beautyful _____
18. practicial _____
19. famouse _____
20. successfull _____

My score: _____ / 20 · 18–20: well done, move on · 14–17: repeat the Part B lessons you got wrong · below 14: repeat the dictation tomorrow

Day 5 Double Consonants, Silent Letters and Vowel Confusion

Learning objectives

By the end of today you will be able to:

- spell **57 of the most-misspelt words in English**, many of which are IELTS Section 1 favourites (*accommodation, address, questionnaire, receipt, Wednesday*);
- use the **doubling rule** to decide between one and two consonants;
- remember where the **silent letters** are;
- choose between **ie/ei, ea/ee, ai/ay** and **ou/ow**;
- write **difficult consonant groups** (*ph, gh, ch, tch, dge, qu, sc*) and use **British spelling** consistently.

Part A: Double consonants

⚠️ **A double consonant sounds exactly like a single one.** *Comittee* and *committee* sound the same, so you have to remember the letters.

The doubling rule (adding -ed, -ing, -er, -ence)

Double the last consonant when **all three** of these are true:

1. the word ends in **one vowel + one consonant** (*begin, occur, plan, stop*);
2. the **last syllable is stressed** (be**GIN**, oc**CUR**; all one-syllable words count);
3. the suffix **starts with a vowel** (*-ed, -ing, -er, -ence, -able*).

Double ✅	Don't double ❌ (stress is not on the last syllable)
be**gin** → begi**nn**ing	**vi**sit → visi**t**ed
oc**cur** → occu**rr**ed, occu**rr**ence	**o**pen → ope**n**ing
re**fer** → refe**rr**ed	**lis**ten → liste**n**ing
pre**fer** → prefe**rr**ed	**of**fer → offe**r**ed
ad**mit** → admi**tt**ed	de**vel**op → develo**p**ed, develo**p**ment
plan → pla**nn**ing · stop → sto**pp**ed · swim → swi**mm**ing	**ben**efit → benefi**t**ed

⚠️ **British exception: a final -l after one vowel always doubles**, wherever the stress is: travel → trave**ll**ed, trave**ll**er · cancel → cance**ll**ed, cance**ll**ation · label → labe**ll**ed · model → mode**ll**ing · level → leve**ll**ed · marvel → marve**ll**ous · counsel → counse**ll**or. (American English uses one *l*. Pick one style.)

Add, don't drop: prefixes and -ly / -ness

When you add a prefix or -ly / -ness, **keep every letter** of both parts:

Part 1	Part 2	Word
dis	appear	di**s**appear (one s)
dis	satisfied	di**ss**atisfied (two s)
mis	spell	mi**ss**pell
un	necessary	u**nn**ecessary

Part 1	Part 2	Word
im / ir / il	mature / regular / legal	i**mm**ature / i**rr**egular / i**ll**egal
final / real / usual	ly	fina**ll**y / rea**ll**y / usua**ll**y
careful / successful	ly	carefu**ll**y / successfu**ll**y
open / sudden	ness	ope**nn**ess / sudde**nn**ess

Word list A: Double consonants (18)

Word · IPA · Part of speech	Meaning	Example sentence	❌ Common mistake
accommodation /əˌkɒməˈdeɪʃn/ *n*	a place to stay or live	**Accommodation** is included.	accomodation, acommodation
occurrence /əˈkʌrəns/ *n*	something that happens	Floods are a rare **occurrence**.	occurence, ocurrence
committee /kəˈmɪti/ *n*	a group that makes decisions	The **committee** meets monthly.	commitee, comittee
necessary /ˈnesəsəri/ *adj*	needed	Is a visa **necessary**?	neccessary, necesary
successful ★ /səkˈsesfl/ *adj*	achieving what you want	The event was very **successful**.	successfull, sucessful
beginning /bɪˈgɪnɪŋ/ *n*	the start	Come at the **beginning** of term.	begining, beggining
tomorrow /təˈmɒrəʊ/ *adv, n*	the day after today	The shop opens **tomorrow**.	tommorow, tomorow
address /əˈdres/ *n, v*	where you live; an email location	What's your email **address**?	adress, addres
parallel /ˈpærəlel/ *adj, n*	side by side, never meeting	Park Road is **parallel** to the river.	paralell, parralel
millennium /mɪˈleniəm/ *n*	1,000 years	The bridge opened in the new **millennium**.	millenium, milennium
embarrass /ɪmˈbærəs/ *v*	to make someone feel shy or ashamed	Don't **embarrass** me!	embarass, embarras
recommend /ˌrekəˈmend/ *v*	to advise or suggest	I **recommend** the fish.	reccomend, recomend
disappear /ˌdɪsəˈpɪə(r)/ *v*	to go out of sight	The birds **disappear** in winter.	dissapear, disapear
occasion /əˈkeɪʒn/ *n*	a special event; a time	It's a special **occasion**.	ocassion, occassion
opportunity /ˌɒpəˈtjuːnəti/ *n*	a chance	It's a great **opportunity**.	oportunity, oppurtunity
professional /prəˈfeʃənl/ *adj, n*	relating to a job; an expert	Get **professional** advice.	proffesional, profesional
questionnaire /ˌkwestʃəˈneə(r)/ *n*	a set of written questions	Please fill in the **questionnaire**.	questionaire, questionnair
mammal ★ /ˈmæml/ *n*	an animal that feeds its young milk	Whales are **mammals**.	mamal, mammel

Part B: Silent letters

Silent-letter patterns

Pattern	Silent letter	Examples
kn- at the start	k	**k**now, **k**nowledge, **k**nee, **k**nife, **k**nock
wr- at the start	w	**w**rite, **w**rong, **w**rist, **w**rap
-mb at the end	b	clim**b**, thum**b**, bom**b**, plum**b**er, com**b**
-bt	b	dou**b**t, de**b**t, su**b**tle
-mn at the end	n	autum**n**, colum**n**, solem**n**
-gn	g	si**g**n, desi**g**n, forei**g**n, campai**g**n, rei**g**n
ps-, pn- at the start	p	**p**sychology, **p**sychologist, **p**neumonia
-sten, -stle	t	lis**t**en, fas**t**en, cas**t**le, whis**t**le, Chris**t**mas
h after *r, g, w* and at some starts	h	r**h**ythm ★, g**h**ost, w**h**ich, **h**our, **h**onest, **h**onour
gu-	u	g**u**arantee, g**u**ide, g**u**est, g**u**itar ★, g**u**ess
-alk, -alf, -alm, -ould	l	wa**l**k, ta**l**k, ha**l**f, ca**l**m, sa**l**mon, cou**l**d, shou**l**d
other	various	i**s**land, ai**s**le, receip**t**, We**d**nesday, mor**t**gage, ve**h**icle, s**c**ience, mus**c**le, s**c**issors, cu**p**board, ans**w**er

Letters you don't hear because the vowel disappears

In fast speech, some syllables vanish. The letters are still there.

You hear	You write
/ˈwenzdeɪ/ (2 syllables)	**Wed**-nes-day
/ˈfebruəri/ or /ˈfebjuəri/	Feb-**r**u-ar-y (r-u-a-r-y)
/ˈbɪznəs/ (2 syllables)	bus-**i**-ness
/ˈvedʒtəbl/ (3 syllables)	veg-**e**-ta-ble
/ˈtemprətʃə/	tem-**per**-a-ture
/ɪnˈvaɪrənmənt/	en-vi-ron-**ment** (the *n* before *m*)
/ˈgʌvənmənt/	gov-er**n**-ment (the *n* before *m*)
/ˈlaɪbri/	li-**br**a-ry
/ˈdɪfrənt/	dif-**fer**-ent

Word list B: Silent letters (17)

Word · IPA · Part of speech	Meaning	Example sentence	❌ Common mistake
Wednesday /ˈwenzdeɪ/ *n*	the day after Tuesday	The class is on **Wednesday**.	Wensday, Wendsday
receipt /rɪˈsiːt/ *n*	a paper proving you paid	Keep your **receipt**.	reciept, receit
island /ˈaɪlənd/ *n*	land with water all around	They live on a small **island**.	iland, ailand
rhythm ★ /ˈrɪðəm/ *n*	a regular beat	Clap to the **rhythm**.	rythm, rhythem

Word · IPA · Part of speech	Meaning	Example sentence	❌ Common mistake
knowledge /ˈnɒlɪdʒ/ *n*	what you know	You need basic **knowledge** of Excel.	knowlege, nowledge
foreign /ˈfɒrən/ *adj*	from another country	Do you speak a **foreign** language?	foriegn, foren
autumn /ˈɔːtəm/ *n*	the season after summer	Leaves fall in **autumn**.	autum, autamn
mortgage /ˈmɔːgɪdʒ/ *n*	a loan to buy a house	They have a 25-year **mortgage**.	morgage, mortage
psychology /saɪˈkɒlədʒi/ *n*	the study of the mind	She studies **psychology**.	sychology, psycology
campaign /kæmˈpeɪn/ *n*	an organised effort	It's an anti-litter **campaign**.	campain, campagne
honest /ˈɒnɪst/ *adj*	telling the truth	Please give an **honest** answer.	onest, honist
doubt /daʊt/ *n, v*	not being sure	I **doubt** it will rain.	dout, doupt
guarantee /ˌgærənˈtiː/ *n, v*	a promise to repair or replace	It has a one-year **guarantee**.	garantee, guarentee
February /ˈfebruəri/ *n*	the second month	The course starts in **February**.	Febuary, Febraury
business /ˈbɪznəs/ *n*	a company; buying and selling	She runs her own **business**.	buisness, bussiness
environment /ɪnˈvaɪrənmənt/ *n*	the natural world; surroundings	We must protect the **environment**.	enviroment, envirnment
government /ˈgʌvənmənt/ *n*	the people who run a country	The **government** cut taxes.	goverment, govenment

Part C: Vowel combinations

ie or ei?

The rule: *i before e, except after c, when the sound is /iː/.*

ie (sound /iː/)	ei after c (sound /iː/)	ei (sound /eɪ/, as in *eight*)
bel**ie**ve, ach**ie**ve, f**ie**ld, p**ie**ce, ch**ie**f, br**ie**f, rel**ie**f, th**ie**f, n**ie**ce	rec**ei**ve, c**ei**ling, rec**ei**pt, dec**ei**ve, perc**ei**ve, conc**ei**ve	**ei**ght, w**ei**ght, n**ei**ghbour, fr**ei**ght, v**ei**n, r**ei**gn, b**ei**ge

⚠️ **Exceptions to learn:** s**ei**ze, w**ei**rd, **ei**ther, n**ei**ther, l**ei**sure, prot**ei**n, caff**ei**ne, h**ei**ght, for**ei**gn, th**ei**r · and **cie** words with a /ʃ/ sound: an**cie**nt, effi**cie**nt, suffi**cie**nt, spe**cie**s, so**cie**ty, s**cie**nce.

ea or ee?

There is no reliable rule, so learn the **sound-alike pairs** and the **ea words that don't sound like /iː/**.

ee	ea	Note
m**ee**t (*see someone*)	m**ea**t (*food*)	Same sound /iː/
s**ee**	s**ea**	
w**ee**k (*7 days*)	w**ea**k (*not strong*)	
st**ee**l (*metal*)	st**ea**l (*take*)	
h**ee**l (*foot*)	h**ea**l (*get better*)	
b**ee**ch (*tree*)	b**ea**ch (*sand*)	

ee	ea	Note
-ee at the end for people and agreements: employ**ee**, train**ee**, refug**ee**, attend**ee**, committ**ee**, guarant**ee**, degr**ee**, agr**ee**	**ea = /e/**: br**ea**d, h**ea**d, w**ea**ther, h**ea**lth ★, w**ea**lth, br**ea**kfast, h**ea**vy, r**ea**dy, pl**ea**sant, m**ea**sure, inst**ea**d, thr**ea**t, j**ea**lous · **ea = /eɪ/**: gr**ea**t, br**ea**k, st**ea**k	car**ee**r ★ (two e's) ≠ carr**ier**

ai or ay?

Rule	Examples
ay at the **end** of a word or syllable	d**ay**, w**ay**, p**ay**, st**ay**, holid**ay**, ess**ay**, del**ay**, displ**ay**, Mond**ay**, p**ay**ment, l**ay**er, m**ay**or
ai in the **middle**, before a consonant	tr**ai**n, r**ai**n, w**ai**t, p**ai**nt, m**ai**l, expl**ai**n, cont**ai**n, maint**ai**n, compl**ai**nt, det**ai**l
ay stays when you add an ending…	days, plays, stayed, delayed, displaying, payment
⚠️ …**except** these three	p**ay** → p**ai**d · s**ay** → s**ai**d · l**ay** → l**ai**d
Unstressed **-ain** /ɪn/ or /ən/	capt**ain** ★, mount**ain**, cert**ain**, barg**ain**, curt**ain**, fount**ain**, Brit**ain**

ou or ow?

Rule	Examples
ow at the **end** of a word, and before **n, l, el, er**	h**ow**, n**ow**, all**ow**, t**ow**n, d**ow**n, br**ow**n, cr**ow**d, **ow**l, t**ow**el, v**ow**el, p**ow**er, sh**ow**er, fl**ow**er, t**ow**er
ou in the **middle**, before most other consonants	h**ou**se, s**ou**th, m**ou**th, cl**ou**d, s**ou**nd, gr**ou**nd, acc**ou**nt, am**ou**nt, c**ou**ncil, c**ou**nty, ann**ou**nce, pron**ou**nce
ow can also be /əʊ/	kn**ow**, sh**ow**, sl**ow**, wind**ow**, borr**ow**, tomorr**ow**, foll**ow**, narr**ow**, gr**ow**th
ou has many sounds	/ʌ/ c**ou**ntry, y**ou**ng, d**ou**ble, en**ou**gh, c**ou**sin · /ɜː/ j**ou**rney, j**ou**rnal · /uː/ gr**ou**p, s**ou**p, r**ou**te · /ɔː/ c**ou**rse, s**ou**rce, res**ou**rce, f**ou**r · /ʊ/ c**ou**ld, sh**ou**ld · /ʊə/ t**ou**r, t**ou**rist
⚠️ **pronounce → pronunciation**	The noun **loses the o**: pro-**nun**-ci-a-tion

Word list C: Vowel traps (12)

Word · IPA · Part of speech	Meaning	Example sentence	❌ Common mistake
receive /rɪˈsiːv/ *v*	to get	You'll **receive** a text.	recieve
believe /bɪˈliːv/ *v*	to think something is true	I **believe** it's correct.	beleive, belive
ceiling /ˈsiːlɪŋ/ *n*	the top inside surface of a room	The **ceiling** is very high.	cieling, seiling
leisure /ˈleʒə(r)/ *n*	free time	There's a **leisure** centre nearby.	liesure, leasure
achieve /əˈtʃiːv/ *v*	to succeed in doing	You can **achieve** band 7.	acheive, achive
neighbour /ˈneɪbə(r)/ *n*	a person living next to you	My **neighbour** has a dog.	nieghbour, neibour
height /haɪt/ *n*	how tall something is	What is your **height**?	hight, heigth
queue /kjuː/ *n, v*	a line of waiting people	There was a long **queue**.	que, queu, cue
colleague /ˈkɒliːg/ *n*	a person you work with	My **colleague** will help you.	collegue, colleage
restaurant /ˈrestrɒnt/ *n*	a place to eat a meal	The **restaurant** opens at 6.	restaraunt, resturant
career ★ /kəˈrɪə(r)/ *n*	a job path over a life	She wants a **career** in law.	carrer, carrier

Word · IPA · Part of speech	Meaning	Example sentence	❌ Common mistake
pronunciation /prəˌnʌnsiˈeɪʃn/ *n*	how a word is said	Check the **pronunciation**.	pronounciation

Part D: Weak vowels (the schwa problem)

In these words an unstressed vowel becomes /ə/ or disappears, so you can't hear which letter it is. **Exaggerate the hidden vowel in your head** when you write.

Word · IPA · Part of speech	Meaning	Example sentence	❌ Common mistake
separate /ˈsepərət/ *adj*; /ˈsepəreɪt/ *v*	apart; to divide	Keep them in **separate** boxes.	seperate
definitely /ˈdefɪnətli/ *adv*	certainly	I'll **definitely** come.	definately, defenitely
privilege /ˈprɪvəlɪdʒ/ *n*	a special right	It's a **privilege** to be here.	priviledge, privilage
temperature /ˈtemprətʃə(r)/ *n*	how hot or cold	The **temperature** dropped to 5°.	temprature, tempreture
vegetable /ˈvedʒtəbl/ *n*	a plant eaten as food	Eat more **vegetables**.	vegtable, vegatable
category /ˈkætəgəri/ *n*	a group or type	Choose a **category**.	catagory, categary
desperate /ˈdespərət/ *adj*	in great need	They were **desperate** for water.	desparate
benefit /ˈbenɪfɪt/ *n, v*	an advantage	Exercise has many **benefits**.	benifit, benafit
describe /dɪˈskraɪb/ *v*	to say what something is like	**Describe** the picture.	discribe
hesitate ★ /ˈhezɪteɪt/ *v*	to pause because unsure	Don't **hesitate** to call.	hasitate, hesetate

Part E: Difficult consonant combinations

Group	Sound	Examples
ph	/f/	**ph**ysical ★, **ph**otograph, **ph**armacy, **ph**ysiotherapy, para**ph**rase ★, gra**ph**, s**ph**ere, **ph**enomenon
gh	/f/ or silent	/f/: enou**gh**, tou**gh**, cou**gh**, lau**gh** · silent: ni**gh**t, throu**gh**, dau**gh**ter, thou**gh**t, wei**gh**t
ch	/k/ (Greek words)	s**ch**ool, **ch**emistry, **ch**aracter, ar**ch**itecture, te**ch**nology, me**ch**anic, stoma**ch**, s**ch**edule, ps**ych**ology, a**ch**e
ch	/ʃ/ (French words)	ma**ch**ine, **ch**ef, bro**ch**ure, para**ch**ute, mousta**ch**e
ck vs **k**	/k/	**ck** after a short vowel: lu**ck**y ★, ti**ck**et, po**ck**et, ja**ck**et, pa**ck**age · **k** after a consonant or long vowel: ban**k**, des**k**, ta**k**e
tch vs **ch**	/tʃ/	**tch** after a short vowel: ki**tch**en, ma**tch**, wa**tch**, ske**tch** · **ch** after a consonant or long vowel: lun**ch**, ben**ch**, tea**ch**, coa**ch**
dge vs **ge**	/dʒ/	**dge** after a short vowel: bri**dge**, e**dge**, ju**dge**, fri**dge**, knowle**dge** · **ge** after a consonant or long vowel: chan**ge**, hu**ge**, pa**ge**, colle**ge**
qu	/kw/ or /k/	**qu**ality, **qu**antity, **qu**estion, e**qu**ipment, re**qu**est · /k/: techni**qu**e, uni**qu**e, anti**qu**e, che**qu**e (BrE), mos**qu**e
x / xc	/ks/	e**x**ercise ★, e**x**tremely ★, e**x**pensive, e**x**hibition (silent h) · **xc**: e**xc**ellent, e**xc**ept, e**xc**iting, e**xc**ursion

Group	Sound	Examples
sc	/s/	**sc**ience, **sc**ene, **sc**enery, **sc**issors, di**sc**ipline, fa**sc**inating, con**sc**ious ★, mu**sc**le
wh vs **w**	/w/	**wh**ether (*if*) / **w**eather (*rain*) · **wh**ich / **w**itch · **wh**ale / **w**ales

Part F: British English spelling conventions

IELTS accepts British or American spelling, but **don't mix the two styles in one answer sheet.** This workbook uses British spelling.

British (use these)	American	Pattern
colour, favourite, neighbour, behaviour	color, favorite…	-our / -or
centre, theatre, metre, litre	center, theater…	-re / -er
organise, recognise, analyse	organize, analyze	-ise, -yse / -ize, -yze
travelled, cancelled, traveller, jewellery	traveled, canceled, jewelry	double *l* / single *l*
enrol, fulfil, skilful, instalment	enroll, fulfill, skillful	single *l* / double *l*
licence (*n*), practice (*n*), defence	license, practice, defense	-ce / -se
programme (*TV, course*), cheque, tyre, grey	program, check, tire, gray	
catalogue, dialogue	catalog, dialog	-ogue / -og
aluminium, aeroplane, pyjamas, mould, plough	aluminum, airplane, pajamas, mold, plow	
paediatric, orthopaedic, anaemia	pediatric, orthopedic, anemia	ae / e
storey (*a floor of a building*), enquiry (*a question*), kerb, cosy	story, inquiry, curb, cozy	

Common mistakes and corrections

❌ Wrong	✅ Right	Memory trick
accomodation	**accommodation**	It's big enough for **two c**ots and **two m**attresses
recieve	**receive**	*i before e except after* ***c***
seperate	**separate**	There's **a rat** in sep**a**r**at**e
goverment	**government**	You **govern** a country: govern + ment
enviroment	**environment**	en**viron** + ment: there's **iron** in the environment
buisness	**business**	**bus** + i + ness: go to work by **bus**
tommorow	**tomorrow**	one *m*, two *r*'s: **tom**-or-row
questionaire	**questionnaire**	question + **n** + aire: two *n*'s
restaraunt	**restaurant**	rest + **au** + rant: *rest au rant*
Febuary	**February**	Feb-**r**u-ary: **br** like **br**rr, it's cold
priviledge	**privilege**	there's no *d*, no *edge*: privi-**lege**
untill	**until**	one *l* (but *till* has two)
rythm ★	**rhythm**	**R**hythm **H**elps **Y**our **T**wo **H**ips **M**ove

❌ Wrong	✅ Right	Memory trick
carrer ★	**career**	car + **ee** + r: two *e*'s, one *r*
footbal ★	**football**	foot + **ball**

Exercise 5.1: Single or double?

Each **?** is **one letter or two of the same letter**. Write the complete word.

1. a?o?odation → _____
2. o?u?ence → _____
3. co?i?ee → _____
4. ne?e?ary → _____
5. su?e?ful → _____
6. begi?ing → _____
7. a?re? → _____
8. para?el → _____
9. mi?e?ium → _____
10. emba?a? → _____
11. re?o?end → _____
12. to?o?ow → _____
13. di?a?ear → _____
14. o?asion → _____
15. o?ortunity → _____
16. profe?ional → _____
17. questio?aire → _____
18. ma?al → _____
19. footba? → _____
20. di?erent → _____

Exercise 5.2: Add the ending (doubling rule; use British spelling)

1. begin + ing → _____
2. occur + ed → _____
3. refer + ed → _____
4. visit + ed → _____
5. travel + ed → _____
6. cancel + ing → _____
7. open + ing → _____
8. plan + ing → _____
9. prefer + ed → _____
10. develop + ed → _____
11. admit + ed → _____
12. listen + ing → _____

Exercise 5.3: Add the missing silent letter

Write the complete word.

1. i_land → _____
2. recei_t → _____
3. We_nesday → _____
4. _nowledge → _____
5. autum_ → _____
6. dou_t → _____
7. r_ythm → _____
8. lis_en → _____
9. forei_n → _____
10. _sychology → _____
11. mor_gage → _____
12. _onest → _____
13. campai_n → _____
14. g_arantee → _____
15. Feb_uary → _____
16. bus_ness → _____

Exercise 5.4: ie or ei?

1. bel_____ve
2. rec_____ve
3. c_____ling
4. l_____sure
5. ach_____ve
6. rec_____pt
7. f_____ld
8. w_____ght
9. n_____ghbour
10. p_____ce
11. for_____gn
12. sc_____nce
13. ch_____f
14. h_____ght
15. effic_____nt
16. s_____ze
17. w_____rd
18. rel_____f
19. dec_____ve
20. anc_____nt

Exercise 5.5: Vowel pairs

A. Circle the correct word.

1. Let's (**meet / meat**) at the main entrance.
2. I'm vegetarian, so I don't eat (**meet / meat**).
3. The (**weather / whether**) will be cold tomorrow.
4. I don't know (**weather / whether**) the museum is open.
5. The shop is open seven days a (**week / weak**).
6. The Wi-Fi signal is very (**week / weak**) here.

B. Complete with ai, ay, ou or ow.

7. The flight was del_____ed by two hours.
8. We p_____d by credit card.
9. The hotel is near the mount_____ns.
10. Each room has a private sh_____er.
11. What's the total am_____nt?
12. pronounce → (noun) _____

Exercise 5.6: Find and correct the spelling mistake

1. accomodation → _____
2. recieve → _____
3. seperate → _____
4. goverment → _____
5. enviroment → _____
6. buisness → _____
7. tommorow → _____
8. questionaire → _____
9. restaraunt → _____
10. Febuary → _____
11. priviledge → _____
12. untill → _____

Dictation 5

► Play **Day5_Dictation.wav**. Write each word once.

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____
6. _____
7. _____
8. _____
9. _____
10. _____
11. _____
12. _____
13. _____
14. _____
15. _____
16. _____
17. _____
18. _____
19. _____
20. _____

Day 5 Assessment (20 marks)

A. Circle the correct spelling. (10 marks)

1. a) accommodation b) accomodation c) acommodation
2. a) comittee b) committee c) commitee
3. a) recieve b) receve c) receive
4. a) separate b) seperate c) separete
5. a) enviroment b) environment c) enviornment
6. a) questionnaire b) questionaire c) questionnair
7. a) Wensday b) Wednesday c) Wendsday
8. a) reciept b) receit c) receipt
9. a) definately b) definitely c) defenitely
10. a) restaurant b) restaraunt c) resturant

B. Write ie or ei, then the whole word. (5 marks)

11. ach_ve → _____
12. c_ling → _____
13. l_sure → _____
14. bel_ve → _____
15. for_gn → _____

C. Correct the spelling. (5 marks)

16. goverment _____
17. buisness _____
18. tommorow _____
19. rythm _____
20. untill _____

My score: _____ / 20 · 18–20: well done, move on · 14–17: repeat Exercises 5.1 and 5.4 · below 14: repeat the dictation tomorrow

Day 6 IELTS Listening Vocabulary Bank

Learning objectives

By the end of today you will be able to:

- spell **120 high-frequency IELTS Listening words** in the 10 topic areas that appear again and again in Sections 1–4;
- recognise the **spelling trap** in each word (the ❌ column shows the usual mistake);
- link today's words to the **rules from Days 1–5**;
- check an answer sheet the way an examiner does.

> 💡 **How to study 120 words in one day:** do **not** try to learn them all at once. Read one topic (12 words), **cover the Word column**, read the meaning, and write the word. Tick the words you got right. Then go to the next topic. At the end, go back **only** to the words you didn't tick.
>
> ⚠️ Words already taught on Days 1–5 are **not repeated** here. They are listed under each topic as **"Also from Days 1–5"**, so revise them too.

1. University and education

Word · IPA · Part of speech	Meaning	Example sentence	❌ Common mistake
lecture /ˈlektʃə(r)/ *n*	a formal talk to students	The **lecture** is in Room 4.	lecutre, lectur
seminar /ˈsemɪnɑː(r)/ *n*	a small discussion class	Bring your notes to the **seminar**.	seminer, semenar
tutorial /tjuːˈtɔːriəl/ *n*	a class with a tutor and a few students	My **tutorial** is on Thursday.	tutorail, tutoriel
assignment /əˈsaɪnmənt/ *n*	a piece of work set by a teacher	The **assignment** is 2,000 words.	asignment, assinment
deadline /ˈdedlaɪn/ *n*	the latest time to finish	The **deadline** is 5 pm Friday.	dedline, dead line
curriculum /kəˈrɪkjələm/ *n*	the subjects in a course (pl. *curricula*)	Music is part of the **curriculum**.	curriculam, curiculum
dissertation /ˌdɪsəˈteɪʃn/ *n*	a long essay for a degree	My **dissertation** is on bees.	disertation, dissertasion
bibliography /ˌbɪbliˈɒgrəfi/ *n*	a list of books and sources used	Add a **bibliography** at the end.	bibliografy, bibliograpy
undergraduate /ˌʌndəˈgrædʒuət/ *n*	a student doing a first degree	It's an **undergraduate** course.	undergraduete, undergradute
enrolment /ɪnˈrəʊlmənt/ *n*	official registration on a course (BrE)	**Enrolment** closes on 1 May.	enrolement (AmE: *enrollment*)
scholarship /ˈskɒləʃɪp/ *n*	money given to pay for study	She won a **scholarship**.	scholership, schoolarship
semester /sɪˈmestə(r)/ *n*	half of a university year	The **semester** starts in September.	semestre, semister

Also from Days 1–5: library · laboratory · vocabulary · questionnaire · attendance · reference · assistant · knowledge · dictionary · psychology · science

2. Accommodation and housing

Word · IPA · Part of speech	Meaning	Example sentence	❌ Common mistake
landlord /ˈlændlɔːd/ *n*	a person who rents out a home	The **landlord** fixed the boiler.	lanlord, landlort
deposit /dɪˈpɒzɪt/ *n*	money paid first and returned later	The **deposit** is one month's rent.	deposite, diposit
furnished /ˈfɜːnɪʃt/ *adj*	with furniture included	Is the flat **furnished**?	furnised, furnishd
utilities /juːˈtɪlətiz/ *n pl*	gas, water and electricity services	**Utilities** are not included.	utilites, utilitys
neighbourhood /ˈneɪbəhʊd/ *n*	the area around your home	It's a safe **neighbourhood**.	nieghbourhood, neighbourhod
garage /ˈgærɑːʒ/ *n*	a building for a car	There's a **garage** at the back.	garrage, garaje
balcony /ˈbælkəni/ *n*	a platform outside an upstairs window	The flat has a small **balcony**.	balconny, balcany
cupboard /ˈkʌbəd/ *n*	a small cabinet with shelves	Plates are in the **cupboard**.	cubboard, cupbord
wardrobe /ˈwɔːdrəʊb/ *n*	a tall cupboard for clothes	Each room has a **wardrobe**.	wardrop, wordrobe
refrigerator /rɪˈfrɪdʒəreɪtə(r)/ *n*	a fridge	The **refrigerator** is new.	refridgerator, refrigirator
terraced /ˈterəst/ *adj*	(a house) joined to the houses on each side	They rent a **terraced** house.	terrased, teraced
apartment /əˈpɑːtmənt/ *n*	a flat	It's a two-bedroom **apartment**.	appartment, apartmant

Also from Days 1–5: accommodation · tenant · resident · residence · maintenance · vacant · mortgage · ceiling · neighbour · temporary · permanent · convenient

3. Employment and careers

Word · IPA · Part of speech	Meaning	Example sentence	❌ Common mistake
employee /ɪmˈplɔɪiː/ *n*	a person who works for a company	We have 50 **employees**.	employe, employie
qualification /ˌkwɒlɪfɪˈkeɪʃn/ *n*	an exam passed or a skill you have	What **qualifications** do you have?	qualifcation, qualafication
vacancy /ˈveɪkənsi/ *n*	a job that is free	There's a **vacancy** for a cook.	vacency, vacansy
recruitment /rɪˈkruːtmənt/ *n*	finding new staff	She works in **recruitment**.	recruitement, recrutment
personnel /ˌpɜːsəˈnel/ *n*	the staff of a company	Only **personnel** may enter.	personel, personal (= private)
supervisor /ˈsuːpəvaɪzə(r)/ *n*	a person who manages workers	Ask your **supervisor**.	supervisior, supervizer
promotion /prəˈməʊʃn/ *n*	a move to a higher job	He got a **promotion**.	promosion, promtion
pension /ˈpenʃn/ *n*	money paid after you retire	The job includes a **pension**.	pention, pensoin

Word · IPA · Part of speech	Meaning	Example sentence	❌ Common mistake
apprenticeship /əˈprentɪsʃɪp/ *n*	training on the job for a trade	He's doing a plumbing **apprenticeship**.	aprenticeship, apprentiship
receptionist /rɪˈsepʃənɪst/ *n*	a person at the front desk	The **receptionist** will give you a key.	recepsionist, receptionest
interview /ˈɪntəvjuː/ *n, v*	a formal meeting for a job	The **interview** is at 10.	interveiw, intervew
internship /ˈɪntɜːnʃɪp/ *n*	a short work-experience job	She did a summer **internship**.	intership, internshipp

Also from Days 1–5: career ★ · salary · applicant · assistant · accountant · colleague · experience · secretary · professional · business · opportunity · competent

4. Travel and transportation

Word · IPA · Part of speech	Meaning	Example sentence	❌ Common mistake
departure /dɪˈpɑːtʃə(r)/ *n*	leaving	Check the **departure** board.	depature, departur
destination /ˌdestɪˈneɪʃn/ *n*	where you are going	Rome is a popular **destination**.	destenation, destinaton
luggage /ˈlʌgɪdʒ/ *n* (uncountable)	bags and cases	Leave your **luggage** here.	lugage, luggages
passenger /ˈpæsɪndʒə(r)/ *n*	a person travelling in a vehicle	**Passengers** must wear seat belts.	passanger, pasenger
reservation /ˌrezəˈveɪʃn/ *n*	a booking	I have a **reservation** for two.	resarvation, reservasion
excursion /ɪkˈskɜːʃn/ *n*	a short organised trip	There's an **excursion** to the lake.	excurtion, exkursion
souvenir /ˌsuːvəˈnɪə(r)/ *n*	something bought to remember a place	I bought a **souvenir**.	souvenier, suvenir
carriage /ˈkærɪdʒ/ *n*	a section of a train (BrE)	First class is in **carriage** A.	carrige, cariage
pedestrian /pəˈdestriən/ *n*	a person walking in the street	Watch out for **pedestrians**.	pedestrain, pedistrian
cancellation /ˌkænsəˈleɪʃn/ *n*	stopping a booking	There's a fee for **cancellation**.	cancelation (AmE), cancellasion
brochure /ˈbrəʊʃə(r)/ *n*	a small information booklet	Take a free **brochure**.	brochur, broshure
terminal /ˈtɜːmɪnl/ *n*	an airport or bus building	Flights leave from **Terminal** 2.	termenal, terminel

Also from Days 1–5: itinerary · distance · tunnel · travelled · insurance · allowance · entrance · queue · stationary · centre

5. Health and lifestyle

Word · IPA · Part of speech	Meaning	Example sentence	❌ Common mistake
nutrition /njuˈtrɪʃn/ *n*	food and how it affects health	Good **nutrition** is important.	nutricion, nutriton
protein /ˈprəʊtiːn/ *n*	a food nutrient in meat, eggs, beans	Eggs are rich in **protein**.	protien (ei exception)

Word · IPA · Part of speech	Meaning	Example sentence	❌ Common mistake
vitamin /ˈvɪtəmɪn/ *n*	a natural substance needed for health	Oranges contain **vitamin** C.	vitamine, vitamen
symptom /ˈsɪmptəm/ *n*	a sign of illness	A cough is a common **symptom**.	symtom, simptom
prescription /prɪˈskrɪpʃn/ *n*	a doctor's written order for medicine	You need a **prescription**.	perscription, prescribtion
pharmacy /ˈfɑːməsi/ *n*	a shop selling medicine	The **pharmacy** is next to the bank.	farmacy, pharmasy
physiotherapy /ˌfɪziəʊˈθerəpi/ *n*	treatment of the body by exercise and massage	She needs **physiotherapy**.	fisiotherapy, physiotheraphy
allergy /ˈælədʒi/ *n*	a bad reaction to food or dust	I have a nut **allergy**.	alergy, allergie
appointment /əˈpɔɪntmənt/ *n*	an arranged meeting time	I have a dental **appointment**.	apointment, appointement
vegetarian /ˌvedʒəˈteəriən/ *n, adj*	a person who eats no meat	Is there a **vegetarian** option?	vegeterian, vegitarian
muscle /ˈmʌsl/ *n*	body tissue that moves the body	Stretch your **muscles**.	mussle, muscel
cholesterol /kəˈlestərɒl/ *n*	a fat in the blood	Check your **cholesterol** level.	colesterol, cholestrol

Also from Days 1–5: patient · surgery · ambulance · temperature · vegetable · physical ★ · exercise ★ · psychology · recovery · health ★ · dairy · leisure

6. Environment and nature

Word · IPA · Part of speech	Meaning	Example sentence	❌ Common mistake
habitat /ˈhæbɪtæt/ *n*	the natural home of an animal or plant	The wetland is a **habitat** for birds.	habbitat, habitate
ecosystem /ˈiːkəʊsɪstəm/ *n*	living things and their environment	Coral reefs are fragile **ecosystems**.	ecosistem, eco-sistem
biodiversity /ˌbaɪəʊdaɪˈvɜːsəti/ *n*	the variety of living things	The forest has high **biodiversity**.	biodiversaty, bio-diversety
conservation /ˌkɒnsəˈveɪʃn/ *n*	protecting nature	She works in wildlife **conservation**.	conservasion, consevation
erosion /ɪˈrəʊʒn/ *n*	wearing away of land by water or wind	Trees reduce soil **erosion**.	erotion, errosion
drought /draʊt/ *n*	a long period without rain	The **drought** lasted two years.	drougth, drout
extinction /ɪkˈstɪŋkʃn/ *n*	when a species no longer exists	Tigers face **extinction**.	extintion, extincsion
oxygen ★ /ˈɒksɪdʒən/ *n*	the gas we breathe	Plants produce **oxygen**.	oxigen, oxygene
reptile /ˈreptaɪl/ *n*	a cold-blooded animal, e.g. a snake	Lizards are **reptiles**.	reptil, reptyle
vegetation /ˌvedʒəˈteɪʃn/ *n*	plants in an area	The island has little **vegetation**.	vegitation, vegetasion
glacier /ˈglæsiə(r)/ *n*	a slow river of ice	The **glacier** is melting.	glaicer, glasier

Word · IPA · Part of speech	Meaning	Example sentence	❌ Common mistake
pesticide /ˈpestɪsaɪd/ *n*	a chemical that kills insects	Farmers use less **pesticide** now.	pestiside, pesticid

Also from Days 1–5: environment · mammal ★ · species · renewable · sustainable · resistant · abundant · island · autumn · scenery · greenery · occurrence

7. Technology

Word · IPA · Part of speech	Meaning	Example sentence	❌ Common mistake
software /ˈsɒftweə(r)/ *n* (uncountable)	computer programs	Install the new **software**.	softwear, softwares
keyboard /ˈkiːbɔːd/ *n*	the keys you type on	The **keyboard** is wireless.	keybord, keyboad
password /ˈpɑːswɜːd/ *n*	a secret word to log in	Change your **password** often.	pasword, passward
database /ˈdeɪtəbeɪs/ *n*	an organised store of data	The **database** has 5,000 names.	datebase, data base
wireless /ˈwaɪələs/ *adj*	without cables	Is there **wireless** internet?	wirless, wireles
technician /tekˈnɪʃn/ *n*	a person who repairs technical equipment	A **technician** will fix it.	technitian, tecnician
innovation /ˌɪnəˈveɪʃn/ *n*	a new idea or method	It's a great **innovation**.	inovation, innovasion
engineering /ˌendʒɪˈnɪərɪŋ/ *n*	designing machines and structures	He studies civil **engineering**.	enginering, engeneering
satellite /ˈsætəlaɪt/ *n*	an object that orbits the Earth	The image came from a **satellite**.	satelite, sattelite
broadband /ˈbrɔːdbænd/ *n*	fast internet connection	**Broadband** is included in the rent.	brodband, broardband
attachment /əˈtætʃmənt/ *n*	a file sent with an email	Open the **attachment**.	attachement, atachment
microphone /ˈmaɪkrəfəʊn/ *n*	a device that records sound	Speak into the **microphone**.	microfone, mikrophone

Also from Days 1–5: battery · compatible · portable · efficient · technology · machinery · programme / program · device (*n*) ≠ devise (*v*) · analyse · electrical

8. Museums and public facilities

Word · IPA · Part of speech	Meaning	Example sentence	❌ Common mistake
exhibition /ˌeksɪˈbɪʃn/ *n*	a public show of art or objects	The **exhibition** opens on Monday.	exibition, exhibtion
sculpture /ˈskʌlptʃə(r)/ *n*	art made from stone, metal or wood	The **sculpture** is made of bronze.	sculpure, sculptor (= the artist)
exhibit /ɪgˈzɪbɪt/ *n*	one object in a museum	Don't touch the **exhibits**.	exibit, exhibet

Word · IPA · Part of speech	Meaning	Example sentence	❌ Common mistake
admission /ədˈmɪʃn/ *n*	the right to enter; the entry price	**Admission** is free for children.	admision, addmission
auditorium /ˌɔːdɪˈtɔːriəm/ *n*	the seating area of a theatre or hall	The **auditorium** seats 500.	auditorim, oditorium
architecture /ˈɑːkɪtektʃə(r)/ *n*	the design of buildings	The city has fine **architecture**.	architechture, arcitecture
archaeology /ˌɑːkiˈɒlədʒi/ *n*	the study of ancient remains (BrE)	She studies **archaeology**.	archaelogy (AmE: *archeology*)
monument /ˈmɒnjumənt/ *n*	a structure built to remember someone	The **monument** is 30 m tall.	monoment, monumant
statue /ˈstætʃuː/ *n*	a figure of a person in stone or metal	Meet me by the **statue**.	statute (= a law), stature
fountain /ˈfaʊntən/ *n*	a structure that sends water into the air	There's a **fountain** in the square.	fountian, fontain
cloakroom /ˈkləʊkruːm/ *n*	a room to leave coats and bags	Leave your bag in the **cloakroom**.	clockroom, cloackroom
aquarium /əˈkweəriəm/ *n*	a building with fish tanks	The **aquarium** has sharks.	aquarim, acquarium

Also from Days 1–5: gallery · ancient · pottery · entrance · centre · theatre · audience · accessible · significance · anniversary · leisure centre

9. Registration and administration

Word · IPA · Part of speech	Meaning	Example sentence	❌ Common mistake
surname /ˈsɜːneɪm/ *n*	family name	Can you spell your **surname**?	sirname, surename
postcode /ˈpəʊstkəʊd/ *n*	letters and numbers in a UK address	What's your **postcode**?	poscode, postcod
signature /ˈsɪgnətʃə(r)/ *n*	your name written by hand	I need your **signature** here.	signiture, signeture
identification /aɪˌdentɪfɪˈkeɪʃn/ *n*	a document proving who you are	Bring photo **identification**.	identifcation, identefication
nationality /ˌnæʃəˈnæləti/ *n*	the country you belong to	What's your **nationality**?	nationallity, nationalaty
occupation /ˌɒkjuˈpeɪʃn/ *n*	your job	**Occupation**: nurse.	ocupation, occupasion
membership /ˈmembəʃɪp/ *n*	being a member of a club	Annual **membership** is £40.	memberhip, membershipp
registration /ˌredʒɪˈstreɪʃn/ *n*	putting your name on an official list	**Registration** starts at 9.	registeration, regestration
enquiry /ɪnˈkwaɪəri/ *n*	a question asking for information (BrE)	Thank you for your **enquiry**.	enquirey, inquery
invoice /ˈɪnvɔɪs/ *n*	a bill for goods or work	We'll send you an **invoice**.	invoise, envoice
emergency /iˈmɜːdʒənsi/ *n*	a sudden dangerous situation	Give an **emergency** contact number.	emergancy, emergensy

Word · IPA · Part of speech	Meaning	Example sentence	❌ Common mistake
application /ˌæplɪˈkeɪʃn/ *n*	a formal request	Send your **application** by email.	aplication, applicasion

Also from Days 1–5: address · receipt · licence · reference · Wednesday · February · questionnaire · necessary · insurance · applicant · eligible · temporary

10. Shopping, services and everyday conversations

Word · IPA · Part of speech	Meaning	Example sentence	❌ Common mistake
cheque /tʃek/ *n*	a written payment order (BrE)	Can I pay by **cheque**?	cheqe, chequ (AmE: *check*)
voucher /ˈvaʊtʃə(r)/ *n*	a paper that can be used instead of money	Here's a £10 **voucher**.	vowcher, vouture
refund /ˈriːfʌnd/ *n*	money returned to you	Can I have a **refund**?	refound, reefund
warranty /ˈwɒrənti/ *n*	a written promise to repair a product	It has a two-year **warranty**.	waranty, warrenty
purchase /ˈpɜːtʃəs/ *n, v*	something bought; to buy	Keep proof of **purchase**.	purchace, perchase
catalogue /ˈkætəlɒg/ *n*	a list or book of products (BrE)	Order from our **catalogue**.	catalouge (AmE: *catalog*)
groceries /ˈgrəʊsəriz/ *n pl*	food and household goods	I buy **groceries** on Saturday.	grocerys, grosseries
cashier /kæˈʃɪə(r)/ *n*	a person who takes payment	Pay the **cashier**.	casheer, cashire
appliance /əˈplaɪəns/ *n*	a machine for the home	Kitchen **appliances** are included.	applience, aplliance
furniture /ˈfɜːnɪtʃə(r)/ *n* (uncountable)	tables, chairs, beds	The **furniture** is new.	furnitures, furnature
bargain /ˈbɑːgən/ *n*	something cheap for its value	At £5, it's a **bargain**!	bargin, bargian
plumber /ˈplʌmə(r)/ *n*	a person who fixes water pipes	Call a **plumber**.	plummer, plumer

Also from Days 1–5: stationery · jewellery · delivery · guarantee · bakery · restaurant · queue · balance · affordable · reasonable · receipt · convenience

Exercise 6.1: Spot the misspelt word

In each group **one** word is wrong. Circle it and write it correctly.

1. lecture · seminer · tutorial → _____
2. assignment · dissertation · bibliografy → _____
3. landlord · furnised · balcony → _____
4. cupboard · wardrobe · refridgerator → _____
5. employee · vacency · pension → _____
6. personel · supervisor · promotion → _____
7. departure · souvenier · passenger → _____
8. luggage · pedestrain · brochure → _____

9. protien · vitamin · symptom → _____

10. pharmacy · perscription · allergy → _____

11. habitat · drougth · erosion → _____

12. sattelite · password · database → _____

13. exibition · sculpture · statue → _____

14. surname · signiture · postcode → _____

15. voucher · warranty · furnitures → _____

Exercise 6.2: Write the word from the meaning

1. money you pay before you move in and get back later → _____
2. gas, water and electricity → _____
3. (a house) joined to the houses on both sides → _____
4. the person who owns the flat you rent → _____
5. a tall cupboard for clothes → _____
6. a person who works for a company → _____
7. a job that is available → _____
8. money you receive after you retire → _____
9. a short organised trip → _____
10. a small booklet with information → _____
11. a doctor's written order for medicine → _____
12. the place where an animal naturally lives → _____
13. a long period with no rain → _____
14. a secret word you use to log in → _____
15. a stone or metal figure of a person → _____
16. a room where you leave your coat → _____
17. your family name → _____
18. your job (on a form) → _____
19. a paper you can use instead of money in a shop → _____
20. a person who repairs water pipes → _____

Exercise 6.3: Mark the answer sheet like an examiner

A student wrote these answers in a Section 1 test. **Tick (✓) the answers that would get a mark. Correct the ones that would score zero.** Then give the student a score out of 15.

1. apartment _____
2. furnished _____
3. neighborhood _____
4. deposite _____
5. utilitys _____
6. recepsionist _____
7. qualifications _____
8. interveiw _____
9. luggages _____
10. reservasion _____
11. vegeterian _____
12. apointment _____
13. broadband _____
14. admision _____
15. catalouge _____

The student's score: _____ / 15

Dictation 6

► Play **Day6_Dictation.wav**. This one has **30 words**. Write each word once.

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____
6. _____
7. _____
8. _____
9. _____
10. _____
11. _____
12. _____
13. _____
14. _____
15. _____
16. _____
17. _____
18. _____
19. _____
20. _____
21. _____
22. _____
23. _____
24. _____
25. _____
26. _____
27. _____
28. _____
29. _____
30. _____

Day 6 Assessment (20 marks)

A. Circle the correct spelling. (10 marks)

1. a) bibliography b) bibliografy c) bibliograpy
2. a) neighborhod b) nieghbourhood c) neighbourhood
3. a) personel b) personnel c) personell
4. a) souvenir b) souvenier c) suvenir
5. a) perscription b) prescribtion c) prescription
6. a) physiotherapy b) fisiotherapy c) physiotheraphy
7. a) biodiversaty b) biodiversity c) biodiversety
8. a) sattelite b) satelite c) satellite
9. a) architechture b) architecture c) arcitecture
10. a) identification b) identifcation c) identefication

B. Write the word. The first letter is given. (10 marks)

11. a list of sources at the end of an essay: b_____
12. a long essay for a degree: d_____
13. a person walking in the street: p_____
14. a booking: r_____

15. a sign of an illness: s_____
16. the variety of living things: b_____
17. a building with fish tanks: a_____
18. a bill for goods or work: i_____
19. a written promise to repair a product: w_____
20. a person who takes payment in a shop: c_____

My score: _____ / 20 · 18–20: well done, move on · 14–17: re-test the topic tables you scored lowest on · below 14: do Exercise 6.2 again tomorrow before Day 7

Day 7 Special Chapter: Singular and Plural Spelling Traps

Learning objectives

By the end of today you will be able to:

- decide **before you listen** whether a gap needs a singular, plural or uncountable noun;
- **hear** plural endings, including the ones that almost disappear (*desks, costs, months*);
- spell **regular and irregular plurals** (*cities, shelves, potatoes, children, criteria*);
- recognise **33 nouns that are the same in the singular and the plural** (*sheep, species, aircraft*);
- never add **-s** to an **uncountable noun** (*information, equipment, accommodation, furniture*);
- write **compound adjectives** correctly (*a ten-minute walk*, not *a ten-minutes walk*).

⚠️ **In IELTS Listening, the number must be exactly right.** If the answer is *tickets* and you write *ticket*, you score **zero**. If the answer is *equipment* and you write *equipments*, you also score **zero**.

Part 1: Hearing plurals

The three sounds of the plural -s

Sound	When	Examples
/s/	after a voiceless sound (/p/, /t/, /k/, /f/, /θ/)	maps, students, books, chefs, months
/z/	after a voiced sound (vowels and /b/, /d/, /g/, /l/, /m/, /n/, /v/)	rooms, bags, fees, tables, hotels, cars
/ɪz/	after /s/, /z/, /ʃ/, /tʃ/, /dʒ/ (adds a syllable)	buses, classes, prizes, dishes, churches, pages, courses
/iːz/	Greek and Latin plurals of *-is* words	crises /ˈkraɪsiːz/, analyses /əˈnæləsiːz/, theses, bases /ˈbeɪsiːz/

Plurals that are hard to hear

Problem	Examples	What you hear
-sts, -sks, -sps (three consonants together)	tests, costs, lists, tourists, scientists, guests, desks, tasks, risks	the last /s/ is very short or seems to disappear
-ths, -cts, -pts	months, lengths, facts, insects, products, receipts, concepts	the /θ/ or /t/ disappears: "*monss*", "*facss*"
Plural + a word starting with s	*tourists stay, shops sell, bikes stolen*	the two /s/ sounds join into one
Plural + a word starting with a vowel	*books are, rooms in, cars on*	the /s/ or /z/ links to the next word: "*book-sare*"

💡 **So don't rely on your ear alone.** Use the **grammar clues** in the question to decide, and then use your ear to confirm.

Part 2: The grammar clues (your "number detector")

Plural clue → add -s	Singular clue → no -s	Uncountable clue → never -s
a number above one: *two, 25, several*	*a / an, one, a single, the only*	*much, a little, less*

Plural clue → add -s	Singular clue → no -s	Uncountable clue → never -s
many, a few, few, various, numerous	*each, every, another*	*an amount of, a great deal of*
a number of, a range of, a variety of, a selection of, a series of	*either, neither*	*a piece of, an item of*
both, these, those, all (the)	*this, that*	(*some, any, a lot of, most* can go with plural **or** uncountable nouns)
one of the …s, each of the …s	*per* (*£5 per person*)	singular verb after the gap: ___ *is provided*
plural verb after the gap: ___ *are / were / have*	singular verb: ___ *is / was / has*	
a pair of, dozens of, hundreds of		

⚠️ **Watch these two:**

- *a number of* students **are** … → plural noun (= *many*)
- *the number of* students **is** … → plural noun after *of*, singular verb (= *the amount*)

Compound adjectives: number + noun + noun → always singular

When a number and a noun come **before another noun**, the first noun **loses its -s** and you add a hyphen.

Phrase	Compound adjective
a walk of **ten minutes**	a **ten-minute** walk
a course that lasts **three days**	a **three-day** course
a flat with **two bedrooms**	a **two-bedroom** flat
a hotel with **five stars**	a **five-star** hotel
a child who is **seven years** old	a **seven-year-old** child
a note worth **twenty pounds**	a **twenty-pound** note
a report of **20 pages**	a **20-page** report

Nouns used as adjectives → usually singular

A noun that describes another noun usually has **no -s**: car park, bus stop, shoe shop, student card, ticket office, tooth**brush**, book club, team player ★ (not *teams player*), apple tree, phone number.

⚠️ **Exceptions** (these nouns are always plural, or the plural has a different meaning): **sports** centre, **clothes** shop, **savings** account, **sales** manager, **customs** officer, **arms** trade, **careers** advice, **goods** train.

Numbers and measurements

✅ Correct	❌ Wrong	Rule
two **hundred** students	two hundreds students	*hundred, thousand, million, dozen* have no -s after a number
hundreds of students	hundred of students	…but they take -s in *hundreds of, thousands of*
six **months**	six month	a plain number + noun → plural
a six-**month** course	a six-months course	a compound adjective → singular
fifty **per cent** / percent	fifty per cents	no -s on *per cent*
20 kg / 20 **kilos**	20 kgs	no -s on abbreviations

Part 3: How to spell regular plurals

Rule	Examples
Most nouns: + s	room → rooms · ticket → tickets · fee → fees
-s, -ss, -sh, -ch, -x, -z: + es	bus → bus**es** · class → class**es** · dish → dish**es** · church → church**es** · box → box**es** · quiz → qui**zz**es
consonant + y → ies	city → cit**ies** · country → countr**ies** · facility → facilit**ies** · activity → activit**ies** · library → librar**ies** · university → universit**ies** · battery → batter**ies** · laboratory → laborator**ies** · allergy → allerg**ies**
vowel + y: + s	day → days · key → keys · holiday → holidays · essay → essays · journey → journeys · survey → surveys · valley → valleys · monkey → monkeys
-f / -fe → ves	knife → kni**ves** · life → li**ves** · wife → wi**ves** · half → hal**ves** · leaf → lea**ves** · shelf → shel**ves** · loaf → loa**ves** · thief → thie**ves** · wolf → wol**ves** · calf → cal**ves**
⚠️ **-f / -fe: + s** (exceptions)	roof → roof**s** · chief → chief**s** · belief → belief**s** · cliff → cliff**s** · proof → proof**s** · chef → chef**s** · safe → safe**s** · giraffe → giraffe**s** · reef → reef**s**
consonant + o → oes	potato → potato**es** · tomato → tomato**es** · hero → hero**es** · echo → echo**es** · volcano → volcano**es** · mosquito → mosquito**es**
-o: + s (vowel + o, short forms, music, Spanish/Italian words)	photo**s** · piano**s** · radio**s** · video**s** · zoo**s** · kilo**s** · studio**s** · logo**s** · memo**s** · kangaroo**s** · tattoo**s** · avocado**s** · casino**s** · ratio**s** · scenario**s** · portfolio**s** · patio**s**
Both accepted	volcanoes / volcanos · mosquitoes / mosquitos · mangoes / mangos · zeros / zeroes · cargoes / cargos · tornadoes / tornados

💡 **Potatoes and tomatoes have toes; photos and pianos don't.**

Part 4: Irregular plurals

Singular	Plural	Singular	Plural
man	**men**	foot	**feet**
woman /ˈwʊmən/	**women** /ˈwɪmɪn/	tooth	**teeth**
child	**children**	goose	**geese**
person	**people**	mouse	**mice**
ox	**oxen**	die	**dice**
businessman, postman	business**men**, post**men**	salesperson	sales**people**

⚠️ **These look irregular but aren't:** German → German**s** · human → human**s** · Norman → Norman**s** (they're not compounds of *man*).

⚠️ **Compounds with "man/woman" as the first word make both parts plural:** a woman doctor → **women doctors**.

Part 5: Nouns with the same singular and plural form (33)

💡 With these nouns, **the verb, the article or the number** tells you whether it is singular or plural. The spelling **never** changes, so never add -s.

Group	Nouns	Example
Animals	sheep · deer · fish · salmon · trout · cod · moose · bison · swine · reindeer · elk · squid	*one sheep, two hundred **sheep***
Offspring	offspring	*The bird feeds its **offspring**.*
Vehicles ending in -craft	aircraft · spacecraft · hovercraft	*Three **aircraft** were delayed.*
Words ending in -s	species /ˈspiːʃiːz/ · series /ˈsɪəriːz/ · means · crossroads · headquarters · barracks · chassis /ˈʃæsi/ (pl. /ˈʃæsiz/) · corps /kɔː/ (pl. /kɔːz/)	*This **species** is rare. These **species** are rare.*
Nationalities ending in -ese and -ss	Swiss · Chinese · Japanese · Portuguese	*The **Japanese** are known for…*
Numbers after a number	dozen · hundred · thousand · million	*two **dozen** eggs, three **thousand** people*
British weight	stone	*He weighs 12 **stone**.*

⚠️ ***Fishes*** exists, but only for **different types** of fish in science. In everyday English and IELTS answers, write **fish**.

Part 6: Latin and Greek plurals (common in Sections 3 and 4)

Pattern	Singular → Plural
-is → -es /iːz/	analysis → analy**ses** · basis → ba**ses** · crisis → cri**ses** · thesis → the**ses** · hypothesis → hypothe**ses** · diagnosis → diagno**ses** · oasis → oa**ses** · emphasis → emphas**es** · axis → ax**es**
-on → -a	phenomenon → phenomen**a** · criterion → criteri**a**
-um → -a	datum → dat**a** · medium → medi**a** · curriculum ★ → curricul**a** (or *curriculums*) · bacterium → bacteri**a** · millennium → millenni**a** · memorandum → memorand**a** · stratum → strat**a**
-us → -i	fungus → fung**i** · cactus → cact**i** · nucleus → nucle**i** · stimulus → stimul**i** · radius → radi**i** · alumnus → alumn**i** · syllabus → syllab**i** (or *syllabuses*)
-a → -ae	larva → larv**ae** · alga → alg**ae** · vertebra → vertebr**ae** · formula → formul**ae** (or *formulas*) · antenna → antenn**ae** (insects; for radios: *antennas*)
-ix / -ex → -ices	appendix → append**ices** · index → ind**ices** · matrix → matr**ices** (or *-ixes / -exes*)
⚠️ **-us → -uses (ordinary English plural)**	campus → camp**uses** · virus → vir**uses** · bonus → bon**uses** · bus → bus**es** · census → cens**uses** · status → stat**uses** (*not* cami, viri)

💡 **One criterion, many criteria. One phenomenon, many phenomena.** The **-on** is singular, and the **-a** is plural.

Part 7: Nouns that are always plural

These have **no singular form** in their normal meaning. They take a **plural verb**, and you count them with **a pair of** or **some**.

Group	Nouns
Clothes and tools in two parts (use *a pair of*)	trousers · jeans · shorts · pyjamas · tights · glasses · sunglasses · binoculars · scissors · pliers · headphones
Things and places	clothes · goods · belongings · valuables · groceries · surroundings · outskirts · premises · stairs · contents · remains · refreshments
Money	savings · earnings · funds (*in the sense of money*)

Group	Nouns
Other	congratulations · thanks · customs (*at the border*) · arms (*weapons*) · headquarters

*My **glasses are** on the desk. Please take all your **belongings**. The **outskirts** of the city **are** quiet.*

Part 8: Words ending in -s that are singular

Group	Nouns	Example
News	news	*The **news is** good.* (never *a news*: use *a piece of news*)
School subjects in -ics	physics · mathematics · economics · statistics · politics · linguistics · electronics · athletics · gymnastics	***Economics is** my favourite subject.*
Illnesses	measles · diabetes · mumps	***Diabetes is** common.*
Games	billiards · darts · dominoes	***Darts is** popular in pubs.*

⚠️ When *statistics* means **numbers**, it is plural: *These statistics show a rise.*

Part 9: Uncountable nouns (never add -s)

These are the **most common IELTS trap**. Learn this list.

Group	Uncountable nouns
Information and study	information · advice · knowledge · research · homework · schoolwork ★ · coursework · feedback · evidence · progress · training · education · assistance · guidance · permission · software
Things	equipment · furniture · luggage · baggage · machinery · stationery · jewellery · clothing · cutlery · crockery · hardware · rubbish · litter · money · cash · post / mail
Places and systems	**accommodation** (in British English) · traffic · transport · parking · housing · scenery · wildlife · vegetation
Nature	weather · pollution · damage · electricity · water · air · oxygen · sunshine · rain · snow · fog
Activities and ideas	work · travel · employment · unemployment · insurance · leisure · fun · health · music · luck · behaviour
Food	bread · rice · pasta · meat · cheese · milk · butter · sugar · fruit (usually)

How to count an uncountable noun

❌ Wrong	✅ Right
an advice, two advices	**a piece of** advice, **some** advice
an information	**a piece of** information, **some** information
two furnitures	**two pieces of** furniture
three luggages	**three pieces of** luggage / **three bags**
an equipment	**a piece of** equipment
a news	**a piece of** news
a bread	**a loaf of** bread / **a slice of** bread
a clothing	**an item of** clothing / **a piece of** clothing
a research	**a piece of** research / **a research project**

❌ Wrong	✅ Right
a travel	**a trip** / **a journey**

⚠️ ***Accommodation*** is uncountable in British English (*accommodations* is American). If the answer is *accommodation*, write it **without -s**.

Part 10: Countable and uncountable, with different meanings

Uncountable	Countable
paper (the material)	**a paper** (a newspaper; an academic article) · **papers** (documents)
work (a job, effort)	**a work** of art · **roadworks**, **gasworks** (places)
experience (knowledge from doing)	**experiences** (things that happened to you)
time	**three times** (occasions)
room (space)	**rooms** (in a building)
glass (the material)	**a glass** (for drinking) · **glasses** (spectacles)
iron (the metal)	**an iron** (for clothes)
business (trade)	**businesses** (companies)
hair (all of it)	**two hairs** (single ones)
coffee / tea (the drink)	**two coffees** (cups of coffee)
chicken (meat)	**chickens** (birds)
competition (rivalry)	**competitions** (contests)
space (the universe; room)	**parking spaces**

Part 11: Collective nouns

Noun	Rule	Example
staff	no -s for people; count with *members of staff*	*two **members of staff*** (not *two staffs*)
police	always plural verb	*The **police are** coming.*
cattle	always plural, no -s	*The **cattle are** in the field.*
people	plural of *person*	***People are** waiting.* (*peoples* = nations, rare)
team, family, government, committee, audience, crew, class	singular or plural verb in British English	*The **team is / are** playing well.*
livestock, poultry	plural meaning, no -s	*The farm sells **livestock**.*

Part 12: Compound nouns and possessives

Type	Rule	Examples
noun + preposition/phrase	the **main** noun takes -s	passer**s**-by · mother**s**-in-law · editor**s**-in-chief · runner**s**-up
verb + particle	the **end** takes -s	grown-up**s** · check-in**s** · take-off**s** · drop-out**s**
one-word compounds	the **end** takes -s	toothbrush**es** · bookshel**ves** · housewi**ves** · spoonful**s**

Type	Rule	Examples
Possessive, one owner	's	a **student's** card (one student)
Possessive, plural owners	s'	the **students'** common room (many students)
Possessive, irregular plural	's	**children's** playground · **women's** clothing · **people's** opinions

⚠️ ***its*** = belonging to it; ***it's*** = it is / it has. *The museum changed **its** opening hours. **It's** open until 6.*

Part 13: The IELTS decision checklist

Use these six steps for every gap in Sections 1–4.

1. **Read around the gap** before the audio starts: the words before **and** after it.
2. **Find the clue:** a number, *a/an*, *several*, *a pair of*, a verb (*is/are*) or a hyphen (*a ___-minute walk*).
3. **Ask: is the noun uncountable?** If it is on the Part 9 list, it can **never** take -s.
4. **Predict** the form and write a small **s?** next to the gap if you expect a plural.
5. **Listen** for /s/, /z/, /ɪz/ or /iːz/. If what you hear doesn't fit the grammar, you probably misheard. The correct answer always fits the sentence.
6. **When you transfer your answers**, check every ending: **-s, -es, -ies, -ves**.

Common mistakes and corrections

❌ Wrong	✅ Right	Why
informations, advices, equipments	**information, advice, equipment**	uncountable (Part 9)
accommodations	**accommodation**	uncountable in British English
furnitures, luggages	**furniture, luggage**	uncountable
schoolworks ★, homeworks	**schoolwork, homework**	uncountable
a ten-minutes walk	**a ten-minute walk**	compound adjective (Part 2)
teams player ★	**team player**	noun used as an adjective
two hundreds people	**two hundred people**	no -s after a number
sheeps, deers, aircrafts	**sheep, deer, aircraft**	same form (Part 5)
a criteria, a phenomena	**a criterion, a phenomenon**	*-a* is the plural (Part 6)
potatos, tomatos	**potatoes, tomatoes**	consonant + o → oes
photoes, pianoes	**photos, pianos**	short forms and music words → os
shelfs, knifes	**shelves, knives**	-f/-fe → ves
rooves	**roofs**	exception: + s
citys, facilitys	**cities, facilities**	consonant + y → ies
holidaies, journies	**holidays, journeys**	vowel + y → + s
childs, peoples	**children, people**	irregular
the news are	**the news is**	*news* is singular
mamals ★	**mammals**	double m; keep the -s when the answer is plural

Exercise 7.1: Write the plural

1. bus → _____
2. box → _____
3. city → _____
4. day → _____
5. knife → _____
6. roof → _____
7. potato → _____
8. photo → _____
9. child → _____
10. person → _____
11. woman → _____
12. tooth → _____
13. mouse → _____
14. sheep → _____
15. species → _____
16. crisis → _____
17. criterion → _____
18. phenomenon → _____
19. analysis → _____
20. bacterium → _____
21. cactus → _____
22. curriculum → _____
23. passer-by → _____
24. mother-in-law → _____
25. spoonful → _____

Exercise 7.2: Correct the uncountable mistakes

Each sentence has **one** mistake. Write the correct phrase.

1. We need some more informations about the course. _____
2. My tutor gave me two useful advices. _____
3. All sports equipments are provided. _____
4. The flat comes with modern furnitures. _____
5. Please do not leave your luggages in the corridor. _____
6. The price includes accommodations for three nights. _____
7. She has done several researches on sleep. _____
8. Students get a lot of homeworks. _____
9. I finished all my schoolworks before dinner. _____
10. Her knowledges of history are excellent. _____
11. There are a lot of traffics in the city centre. _____
12. They found no evidences of damage. _____
13. Thank you for your feedbacks. _____
14. The software are easy to use. _____
15. Here are the news. _____

Exercise 7.3: Singular or plural? Use the grammar clue

Write the correct form of the word in brackets. Some answers need no change.

1. There are several _____ on Monday. (*lecture*)
2. Each _____ must show a student card. (*student*)
3. One of the main _____ is the cost. (*problem*)
4. It's a two-_____ course. (*week*)
5. A number of _____ have complained. (*resident*)
6. Every _____ has a private bathroom. (*room*)

7. Please bring two passport _____. (*photo*)
8. You will need a pair of _____. (*glove*)
9. Neither _____ is cheap. (*option*)
10. Both _____ are cheap. (*option*)
11. There isn't much _____ in the car park. (*space*)
12. A few _____ stayed until midnight. (*tourist*)
13. The fee is £15 per _____. (*person*)
14. Tickets are free for _____ under five. (*child*)
15. The museum has a range of _____ for families. (*activity*)
16. The farm keeps 300 _____. (*sheep*)
17. Add three _____ to the soup. (*tomato*)
18. The kitchen has two _____ for spices. (*shelf*)
19. There is a lot of _____ in the storeroom. (*equipment*)
20. Visitors can see over two _____ species of birds. (*hundred*)

Exercise 7.4: is or are?

1. The news (**is / are**) on at six.
2. My trousers (**is / are**) too long.
3. Physics (**is / are**) a difficult subject.
4. The police (**is / are**) looking for the driver.
5. Two sheep (**was / were**) in the road.
6. This species (**is / are**) only found in Australia.
7. These species (**is / are**) only found in Australia.
8. Mathematics (**is / are**) compulsory.
9. My glasses (**is / are**) broken.
10. The data from the survey (**is / are**) ready. (*both possible: which one is more formal?*)

Exercise 7.5: Make a compound adjective

Rewrite each phrase. Remember: **no -s, and add a hyphen**.

1. a walk of ten minutes → _____
2. a course that lasts three days → _____
3. a flat with two bedrooms → _____
4. a hotel with five stars → _____
5. a boy who is seven years old → _____
6. a note worth twenty pounds → _____
7. a lecture that lasts two hours → _____
8. a report of 20 pages → _____

Dictation 7: Gap completion

► Play **Day7_Dictation.wav**. Each sentence is read **twice**. Write **one word** (a hyphenated word counts as one) in each gap. **Check the number clue before you listen.**

1. There are three new _____ this month.
2. Please bring two passport _____.
3. We need more _____ about the course.
4. The hotel is a _____ walk from the beach.
5. The farm keeps about two hundred _____.
6. Scientists found three new _____ of frog.
7. All sports _____ is provided.
8. Tickets are half price for _____.
9. The room has two _____ for books.
10. The fee includes _____ and meals.
11. Applications are judged on four _____.
12. The town is popular with _____ in summer.
13. The flat comes with _____.
14. Add two _____ to the soup.
15. In autumn, the _____ turn red.
16. You will need a pair of _____.
17. Your tutor will give you _____ on Friday.
18. The course lasts six _____.
19. There are twenty _____ in the classroom.
20. The price covers all travel _____.

Day 7 Assessment (20 marks)

A. Write the plural. (5 marks)

1. facility → _____
2. shelf → _____
3. hypothesis → _____
4. aircraft → _____
5. video → _____

B. Tick (✓) the correct phrases. Correct the wrong ones. (5 marks)

6. a five-days holiday _____
7. some useful information _____

8. three hundreds visitors _____
9. two pieces of furniture _____
10. a lot of luggages _____

C. Complete the notes with the correct form of the word in brackets. (10 marks)

Community Centre: Information for New Members

11. The centre has three meeting _____. (*room*)
12. All sports _____ is available at reception. (*equipment*)
13. There is a 15-_____ break between classes. (*minute*)
14. Members get free _____ on healthy eating. (*advice*)
15. The café sells sandwiches and fresh _____. (*fruit*)
16. Each _____ can bring one guest. (*member*)
17. The pottery class needs two more _____. (*volunteer*)
18. Children's _____ are kept in the cloakroom. (*belonging*)
19. Guided walks to see the _____ start in March. (*deer*)
20. The centre's _____ are in Park Road. (*headquarters*)

My score: _____ / 20 · 18–20: excellent, now do the Final Mastery Test · 14–17: re-read Parts 2 and 9 · below 14: repeat Exercise 7.3 and the dictation tomorrow

Test Final Mastery Test

Take this test **the day after Day 7**, in one sitting, without looking back at the lessons. Allow **40 minutes**.

Section	What it tests	Marks
1	Dictation (audio)	20
2	Choose the correct spelling	10
3	Find and correct the mistake	10
4	Choose the ending	10
5	Singular, plural or uncountable	10
	Total	**60**

Test Section 1: Dictation (20 marks)

► Play **Final_Test_Dictation.wav**. Write each word once.

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____
6. _____
7. _____
8. _____
9. _____
10. _____
11. _____
12. _____
13. _____
14. _____
15. _____
16. _____
17. _____
18. _____
19. _____
20. _____

Test Section 2: Circle the correct spelling (10 marks)

1. a) accomodation b) accommodation c) acommodation
2. a) independant b) independent c) independint
3. a) maintenance b) maintainance c) maintenence
4. a) responsable b) responsibel c) responsible
5. a) stationery b) stationary c) stationry *(pens and paper)*
6. a) recieve b) receive c) receeve
7. a) questionnaire b) questionaire c) questionnair
8. a) occurence b) occurrance c) occurrence
9. a) knowledgable b) knowledgeable c) knowlegeable
10. a) itinerary b) itinery c) itenerary

Test Section 3: Find and correct the mistake (10 marks)

11. The libary opens at 9 am. _____
12. We had a very pleasent stay. _____
13. Bring your passport for identifcation. _____
14. The goverment has announced new rules. _____
15. The course is availible online. _____
16. There was a long que at the bank. _____
17. Your refrence number is 4471. _____
18. The hotel has excelent facilities. _____
19. Please write your adress here. _____
20. It's only a temporery job. _____

Test Section 4: Choose the ending and write the whole word (10 marks)

21. signific (-ant / -ent) → _____
22. exist (-ance / -ence) → _____
23. flex (-able / -ible) → _____
24. machin (-ary / -ery) → _____
25. conveni (-ance / -ence) → _____
26. attend (-ance / -ence) → _____
27. suit (-able / -ible) → _____
28. vocabul (-ary / -ery) → _____
29. consist (-ant / -ent) → _____
30. elig (-able / -ible) → _____

Test Section 5: Singular, plural or uncountable (10 marks)

Complete the notes with the correct form of the word in brackets.

City Tour: Notes

31. The tour includes visits to two art _____. (*gallery*)
32. Please leave all _____ at reception. (*luggage*)
33. The guide has run a three-_____ course on local history. (*month*)
34. Two _____ were seen in the old kitchen. (*mouse*)
35. The best tour is chosen using three _____. (*criterion*)
36. Several _____ of fish live in the castle moat. (*species*)
37. Visitors can get more _____ at the desk. (*information*)
38. The gift shop has four _____ of books. (*shelf*)
39. The market sells two kilos of _____ for £1. (*potato*)
40. Each _____ receives a free map. (*visitor*)

My score: _____ / 60 · **54–60:** mastery, keep up the weekly spelling test · **45–53:** good, so re-learn every wrong word with the Error Log · **below 45:** repeat the day that matches most of your mistakes, then take the test again in 3 days

Bank Real Answer Words: Cambridge 10–19

What this list is

Every **gap-fill answer** in the Listening answer keys of **Cambridge IELTS 10–19** (40 tests, 1,600 questions) was collected. Letter answers (A–H), numbers, times, postcodes and people's or place names were removed. Alternatives such as *garden(s)* or *colour / color* were joined, so singular and plural, and British and American spellings, count as **one word**. Then all duplicates were removed.

Gap-fill answers with words	**825**
Different words after removing duplicates	**623**
Words used **2 or more times** (Part A)	**132**
Words also taught in Days 1–7	**60** (marked ●)

💡 **What the list shows:** most answers are **short, everyday words** (*parking, bridge, map, food, week, insects*), not rare academic words. You lose marks on easy words spelt wrong, a missing **-s**, or a doubled letter. That is why each block below includes the plural forms the key accepted.

How to practise

When	What to do
Each day of the 7-day plan	Learn **one block** of Part A (about 19 words), using Look-Say-Cover-Write-Check. Then play that block's dictation (**AnswerWords_Block1.wav … Block7.wav**) and write the words in the answer lines. The words are read in a different order from the list.
After the 7 days	Work through Part B, **one or two letters a day**. Say each word, cover it and write it. Put every word you get wrong in the Error Log.
Before every mock test	Read Part A again quickly. These words have already appeared in real tests more than once.

Times = how many different answers in Cambridge 10–19 used the word.

Part A, Block 1 (Day 1): words 1–19

#	Word	Other forms in the key	Times	Cover and write
1	**parking**		8	
2	**bridge**		5	
3	**garden**	gardens	5	
4	**map**	maps	5	
5	**brain**	brains	4	
6	**family**	families	4	
7	**food** ●	foods	4	
8	**insects**		4	
9	**stress**		4	
10	**training**		4	

#	Word	Other forms in the key	Times	Cover and write
11	**week**	weeks	4	
12	**animal** •	animals	3	
13	**cinema**		3	
14	**dance**	dances	3	
15	**database** •		3	
16	**dentist**		3	
17	**floor**	floors	3	
18	**furniture** •		3	
19	**grass**	grasses	3	

Part A, Block 2 (Day 2): words 20–38

#	Word	Other forms in the key	Times	Cover and write
20	**healthy**		3	
21	**location**		3	
22	**market**		3	
23	**oxygen** •		3	
24	**park**		3	
25	**personality**		3	
26	**river**		3	
27	**sugar**	sugars	3	
28	**time** •		3	
29	**appointment** •	appointments	2	
30	**balance** •		2	
31	**bay**		2	
32	**beginners**		2	
33	**behaviour**	behaviours, AmE: behavior, behaviors	2	
34	**bone**	bones	2	
35	**boots**		2	
36	**breathing**		2	
37	**cattle** •		2	
38	**clouds**		2	

Part A, Block 3 (Day 3): words 39–57

#	Word	Other forms in the key	Times	Cover and write
39	**college**		2	
40	**colour**	AmE: color	2	

#	Word	Other forms in the key	Times	Cover and write
41	**competition** •		2	
42	**complex**		2	
43	**confusion**		2	
44	**customer**	customers	2	
45	**dark**		2	
46	**deliveries**		2	
47	**diary** •		2	
48	**disease**	diseases	2	
49	**dog**	dogs	2	
50	**dry**		2	
51	**employment**		2	
52	**entry**		2	
53	**equipment**		2	
54	**experience** •		2	
55	**fence**	fences	2	
56	**film**		2	
57	**fishing**		2	

Part A, Block 4 (Day 4): words 58–76

#	Word	Other forms in the key	Times	Cover and write
58	**fuel**		2	
59	**glass** •	glasses	2	
60	**harbour**	AmE: harbor	2	
61	**heavy**		2	
62	**helmet**		2	
63	**history**		2	
64	**hospital**		2	
65	**ice**		2	
66	**instrument**	instruments	2	
67	**insurance** •		2	
68	**island** •	islands	2	
69	**lamps**		2	
70	**late**		2	
71	**leader**	leaders	2	
72	**light**	lights	2	
73	**lighting**		2	

#	Word	Other forms in the key	Times	Cover and write
74	**logic**		2	
75	**lunch**		2	
76	**metal**	metals	2	

Part A, Block 5 (Day 5): words 77–95

#	Word	Other forms in the key	Times	Cover and write
77	**migration**		2	
78	**movement**		2	
79	**mud**		2	
80	**museum**		2	
81	**newspaper**	newspapers	2	
82	**oil**		2	
83	**paper** •		2	
84	**passport**		2	
85	**payment**	payments	2	
86	**perfume**		2	
87	**plastic**		2	
88	**play**		2	
89	**political**		2	
90	**poster**	posters	2	
91	**power**	powers	2	
92	**presentation**		2	
93	**price**	prices	2	
94	**problem**	problems	2	
95	**rain**		2	

Part A, Block 6 (Day 6): words 96–114

#	Word	Other forms in the key	Times	Cover and write
96	**relative**	relatives	2	
97	**reproduction**		2	
98	**review**		2	
99	**roads**		2	
100	**rose**	roses	2	
101	**safety**		2	
102	**salt**		2	
103	**September**		2	

#	Word	Other forms in the key	Times	Cover and write
104	**side**	sides	2	
105	**sky**		2	
106	**smartphone**	smartphones	2	
107	**social**		2	
108	**soil**		2	
109	**space** •		2	
110	**speed**		2	
111	**stage**		2	
112	**steam**		2	
113	**structure**	structures	2	
114	**study**		2	

Part A, Block 7 (Day 7): words 115–132

#	Word	Other forms in the key	Times	Cover and write
115	**style**		2	
116	**suit**	suits	2	
117	**tail**	tails	2	
118	**technical**		2	
119	**temporary** •		2	
120	**tent**		2	
121	**Thursday**		2	
122	**tool**	tools	2	
123	**trains**		2	
124	**transport**		2	
125	**tree**	trees	2	
126	**tube**		2	
127	**vision**	visions	2	
128	**wall**	walls	2	
129	**weight**		2	
130	**windows**		2	
131	**women**		2	
132	**wood**		2	

Part A dictations

► Play **AnswerWords_Block1.wav** after studying Block 1, and so on. Each word is read twice. Write the singular form unless you hear a plural.

Block 1

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____
6. _____
7. _____
8. _____
9. _____
10. _____
11. _____
12. _____
13. _____
14. _____
15. _____
16. _____
17. _____
18. _____
19. _____

Block 2

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____
6. _____
7. _____
8. _____
9. _____
10. _____
11. _____
12. _____
13. _____
14. _____
15. _____
16. _____
17. _____
18. _____
19. _____

Block 3

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____
6. _____
7. _____
8. _____
9. _____
10. _____
11. _____
12. _____
13. _____
14. _____
15. _____
16. _____
17. _____
18. _____
19. _____

Block 4

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____
6. _____
7. _____
8. _____
9. _____
10. _____
11. _____
12. _____
13. _____
14. _____
15. _____
16. _____
17. _____
18. _____
19. _____

Block 5

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____
6. _____
7. _____
8. _____
9. _____
10. _____
11. _____
12. _____
13. _____
14. _____
15. _____
16. _____
17. _____
18. _____
19. _____

Block 6

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____
6. _____
7. _____
8. _____
9. _____
10. _____
11. _____
12. _____
13. _____
14. _____
15. _____
16. _____
17. _____
18. _____
19. _____

Block 7

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____
6. _____
7. _____
8. _____
9. _____
10. _____
11. _____
12. _____
13. _____
14. _____
15. _____
16. _____
17. _____
18. _____

Part B: All 623 answer words A–Z

A small number after a word = it was used that many times. ● = also taught in Days 1–7.

A

absence ●
achievement
acid
actor
afternoon
agriculture
airport
alone
ambitions
analysis
animal[3] ●
anxiety
appointment[2] ●
April
art
aspirations
assumption
atlas
attention
attitude
aunt

B

background
balance[2] ●
balancing
balcony ●
band
bar
basic
bath
bay[2]
beach
bees
beginners[2]
behaviour[2]
bicycle
bike
bilingual
bill
birds
blog
blond
blonde
blue
bone[2]
booking
boots[2]
box
brain[4]
breathing[2]
breeding
bridge[5]
budget
bullying
business ●
butterflies

C

cabins
café
calories
camera
canal
capital
capitalism
car
card
carnival
cash
castle
cattle[2] ●
cave
character
cheap
cheese
children
chocolate
choices
choose
cinema[3]
clapping
clarinet
classification
clay
cliffs
climate
clothing
clouds[2]
cloudy
clubs
coconut
code
coffee
coins
collecting
college[2]
colony
colour[2]
comets
comfortable ●
communication
competition[2] ●
complex[2]
complicated
concert
confidence ●
confident ●
confusion[2]
conservation ●
constant ●
consumption
contact
control
convenient ●
cooker
cost
creativity
crime
crow
crying
culture
curtains
curved
customer[2]
cycling

D

damage
damp
dance[3]
dancing
dark[2]
data
database[3] ●
days
decade
decline
declining
decorate
decoration
decrease
delay
deliveries[2]
demand
democratic
dentist[3]
dentist's
depression
design
destinations
destruction
detail
development
diameter
diary[2] ●
dinner
direction
disabled
discount
discs
disease[2]
disturbing
diversity
doctor
dog[2]
drawings
drummer
dry[2]
duck
dust

E

ear
economic
effects
egg
electrician
emotions
employment[2]
endangered
energy
entry[2]
equipment[2]
erosion •
evaluate
evening
evidence •
exhibition •
expansion
experience[2] •
eyes

F

factory
family[4]
fat
father
feathers
feedback
feelings
feet
fence[2]
fertilisers
festivals
film[2]
fire
fish
fishing[2]
fit
fitness
flexible •
flight
flooding
floor[3]
flowers
fluent
flute
focus
food[4] •
forest
fountain •
frame
free
freedom
frequency
fridge
friend
fuel[2]
full
furniture[3] •

G

games •
garage •
garden[5]
gardening
gates
gene
glass[2] •
global
gloves
golden
grammar
grandmother
grandparents
grant
graph
graphic
grass[3]
growth
guests
guided

H

habit
hair •
hairdresser
hand
handbag
harbour[2]
hard
head
health
healthy[3]
heavy[2]
helicopters
helmet[2]
history[2]
holiday
horse
hospital[2]
hostel
hotels
humans

I

ice[2]
identification •
identity
image
income
industry
information
injuries
innovation •
insects[4]
instrument[2]
insurance[2] •
international
island[2] •
isolation
issues

J

jeans
jobs
joining
journalist

K

kitchen
knee
knife

L

ladder
lake
lamps[2]
language
late[2]
leader[2]
leadership
lecture •
library •
light[2]
lighting[2]
litre
litter
lively
local
location[3]
locker
logic[2]
logo
lunch[2]

M

machines
mammals
manager
map[5]
marble
March
market[3]
material
Maths
May
mediator
medical
medication
meditation
meetings
melon
memory
metal[2]
method
microphone •
migration[2]
military •
minutes
model
moist
money •
monkeys
month
monument •
moon
morning
motivation
mountains
mouths
move
movement[2]
movie
mud[2]
museum[2]
mushrooms
music

N

name
nature •
necessary •
neck
negative
nest
network
new
newspaper[2]
night
numbers
nutrients

O

obesity
observation
oceans
October
oil[2]
online
opera
opportunity •
outdoor
oxygen[3] •

P

page
paper[2] •
parade
park[3]
parking[8]
partner
pass
passport[2]
past
patients
payment[2]
peak
people •
percent
perfume[2]
permanent •
personal
personality[3]
phone
photo
physics
picture
plan
plants
plastic[2]
platform
play[2]
playground
plot
podcast
poetry
police •
political[2]
politics
pollution
pool
port
postbox
poster[2]
posts
poverty
power[2]
practical
practice
practise
predictable
prediction
presentation[2]
preservation
price[2]
private
problem[2]
profession
project
protection
protein •
publication
purple
purpose
puzzle

Q

quiz

R

races
rain[2]
rats
receptionist ●
recording
records
recovery ●
rectangular
red
reference ●
regional
regulation
relative[2]
reproduction[2]
resources
respect
return
review[2]
river[3]
roads[2]
rock
roots
rose[2]
rough
round
route
rubber
rules
running

S

safe
safety[2]
salt[2]
samphire
scarf
science ●
scientist
screen
sea
seaweed
secondary ●
seed
self-employed
September[2]
service
settlement
shape
share
sheep
shelter
shirts
shoes
shopping
shops
short
shoulder
shower
side[2]
sign
silent
simple
size
skills
sky[2]
slavery
slaves
slides
smartphone[2]
smell
smile
snack
snakes
social[2]
socialise
society
software ●
soil[2]
solar
son
sounds
space[2] ●
speech
speed[2]
spice
spoons
spring
stadium
stage[2]
stamps
steam[2]
steps
sterling
stone
storage
storms
story
strangers
strawberry
stream
stress[4]
string
structural
structure[2]
study[2]
style[2]
sugar[3]
suit[2]
Sunday
superiority
supermarket
support
surface
survival

T

tail[2]
tailor
talk
tax
taxation
taxi
tea
team
technical[2]
technology
teenagers
telegraph
temperatures
temporary[2] ●
tennis
tent[2]
tests
textile
theme
therapy
thermometer
thousands
Thursday[2]
tickets
tidy
tiger
time[3] ●
timing
tongue
tool[2]
toothpaste
top
tour
tourism
tower
tracking
traditional
training[4]
trains[2]
transport[2]
transportation
travel
travelling
tree[2]
trust
tube[2]
Tuesday

U

uniform
university
unnecessary

V

vacation
variety
vegetarian ●
violin
visible ●
vision[2]
visitors
vitamins
vocabulary ●

W

waist
waiter
wall[2]
waste
water
wealth
weapons
week[4]
weekend
weight[2]
wet
wifi
windows[2]
wine
winter
wire
women[2]
wood[2]
work ●
world
worst

Y

year
yellow
youth

Key Answer Key

Mark your work **letter by letter**. A word with one wrong letter is wrong, just as it is in the exam. Copy every wrong word into the **Error Log** at the back.

Answers: Day 1

Ex 1.1: 1 important · 2 different · 3 assistant · 4 convenient · 5 participant · 6 intelligent · 7 significant · 8 permanent · 9 pleasant · 10 efficient · 11 relevant · 12 consistent · 13 resistant · 14 independent · 15 elegant · 16 diligent · 17 applicant · 18 excellent · 19 tolerant · 20 competent

Ex 1.2: 1 importance · 2 difference · 3 confidence · 4 independence · 5 resistance · 6 patience · 7 absence · 8 frequency · 9 efficiency · 10 relevance · 11 significance · 12 consistency · 13 intelligence · 14 vacancy · 15 permanence

Ex 1.3: 1 assistant · 2 participant · 3 applicant · 4 dependent · 5 resistant · 6 consultant · 7 different · 8 tolerant · 9 resident · 10 hesitant · 11 insistent · 12 reliant

Ex 1.4: 1 convenient · 2 assistant · 3 pleasant · 4 confident (a *confidant* is a person you trust) · 5 participants · 6 excellent · 7 absent · 8 resistant · 9 permanent · 10 frequent · 11 elegant · 12 intelligent

Ex 1.5: 1 assistant · 2 ancient · 3 relevant · 4 significant · 5 constant · 6 independent · 7 patient · 8 present · 9 competent · 10 distant

Assessment: 1 b · 2 c · 3 a · 4 b · 5 c · 6 b · 7 a · 8 b · 9 b · 10 b · 11 independence · 12 significance · 13 patience · 14 relevance · 15 confidence · 16 ✗ resistant · 17 ✓ · 18 ✗ distant · 19 ✗ absent · 20 ✓

Dictation 1 script:

#	Answer	Audio script
1	**important**	It is important to bring your student card.
2	**assistant**	Please speak to the library assistant.
3	**participant**	Each participant will receive a certificate.
4	**significant**	There was a significant rise in prices.
5	**pleasant**	The hotel has a pleasant garden.
6	**constant**	The room is kept at a constant temperature.
7	**brilliant**	She gave a brilliant presentation.
8	**relevant**	Only include relevant information.
9	**convenient**	The bus stop is very convenient.
10	**confident**	I am confident about the interview.
11	**intelligent**	Dolphins are very intelligent animals.
12	**permanent**	This is a permanent job.
13	**excellent**	The food in the canteen is excellent.
14	**ancient**	We visited an ancient temple.
15	**efficient**	The new heating system is more efficient.
16	**frequent**	Trains are more frequent in the morning.
17	**consistent**	Her results have been consistent all year.
18	**independent**	It is an independent school.
19	**resistant**	This jacket is water resistant.

#	Answer	Audio script
20	**applicant**	Every applicant must fill in a form.

Answers: Day 2

Ex 2.1: 1 importance · 2 difference · 3 appearance · 4 existence · 5 performance · 6 experience · 7 attendance · 8 evidence · 9 acceptance · 10 reference · 11 maintenance · 12 preference · 13 guidance · 14 convenience · 15 insurance · 16 intelligence · 17 resistance · 18 conference · 19 distance · 20 sentence

Ex 2.2: 1 importance · 2 difference · 3 confidence · 4 independence · 5 resistance · 6 convenience · 7 excellence · 8 patience · 9 distance · 10 intelligence · 11 appearance · 12 existence · 13 performance · 14 reference · 15 preference · 16 maintenance · 17 occurrence · 18 guidance · 19 attendance · 20 entrance

Ex 2.3: 1 patients · 2 patience · 3 assistants · 4 assistance · 5 presence · 6 presents · 7 Attendance · 8 attendants · 9 residence · 10 residents

Ex 2.4: 1 maintenance · 2 references · 3 experience · 4 evidence · 5 conference · 6 attendance · 7 performance · 8 distance · 9 confidence · 10 insurance

Ex 2.5: 1 vacancy · 2 emergency · 3 frequency · 4 efficiency · 5 currency · 6 agency · 7 fluency · 8 proficiency · 9 consistency · 10 tendency

Assessment: 1 a · 2 b · 3 c · 4 a · 5 b · 6 b · 7 c · 8 a · 9 a · 10 b · 11 acceptance · 12 insurance · 13 conference · 14 intelligence · 15 significance · 16 patients · 17 licence · 18 practice · 19 assistants · 20 presence

Dictation 2 script:

#	Answer	Audio script
1	**importance**	Never forget the importance of sleep.
2	**assistance**	Ask at reception if you need assistance.
3	**appearance**	The building has a modern appearance.
4	**performance**	The performance starts at eight.
5	**attendance**	Attendance at lectures is compulsory.
6	**maintenance**	Call maintenance if the heating breaks.
7	**guidance**	Your tutor will give you guidance.
8	**insurance**	Travel insurance is not included.
9	**distance**	The distance to the beach is two kilometres.
10	**acceptance**	You will receive a letter of acceptance.
11	**difference**	There is a big difference in price.
12	**existence**	The club has been in existence for fifty years.
13	**experience**	You need some experience in sales.
14	**evidence**	There is no evidence of damage.
15	**reference**	Please give the name of one reference.
16	**preference**	Do you have a preference for a window seat?
17	**independence**	Students value their independence.
18	**convenience**	Online shopping offers convenience.
19	**conference**	The conference room is on the second floor.
20	**occurrence**	Floods are a common occurrence here.

Answers: Day 3

Ex 3.1: 1 comfortable · 2 reasonable · 3 available · 4 possible · 5 responsible · 6 accessible · 7 flexible · 8 visible · 9 reliable · 10 suitable · 11 eligible · 12 incredible · 13 sensible · 14 valuable · 15 enjoyable · 16 compatible · 17 affordable · 18 legible · 19 edible · 20 sustainable

Ex 3.2: 1 valuable · 2 reliable · 3 noticeable · 4 manageable · 5 forgettable · 6 believable · 7 changeable · 8 regrettable · 9 usable · 10 knowledgeable · 11 desirable · 12 variable

Ex 3.3: 1 availability · 2 responsibility · 3 flexibility · 4 possibility · 5 reliability · 6 accessibility · 7 sustainability · 8 eligibility · 9 visibility · 10 accountability

Ex 3.4: 1 impossible · 2 irresponsible · 3 illegible · 4 invisible · 5 unreliable · 6 uncomfortable · 7 unacceptable · 8 inflexible · 9 ineligible · 10 irreversible

Ex 3.5: 1 available · 2 responsible · 3 accessible · 4 flexible · 5 reliable · 6 reasonable · 7 eligible · 8 comfortable · 9 valuable · 10 legible

Assessment: 1 b · 2 a · 3 c · 4 b · 5 a · 6 c · 7 b · 8 b · 9 a · 10 c · 11 sustainable · 12 manageable · 13 sensible · 14 forgettable · 15 compatible · 16 impossible · 17 irresponsible · 18 illegible · 19 inaccessible · 20 unavailable

Dictation 3 script:

#	Answer	Audio script
1	**comfortable**	The chairs are very comfortable.
2	**reasonable**	The rent is reasonable.
3	**available**	Tickets are available online.
4	**reliable**	The old car is not reliable.
5	**valuable**	Keep your valuable items in the safe.
6	**suitable**	This course is suitable for beginners.
7	**enjoyable**	It was an enjoyable trip.
8	**remarkable**	The view from the top is remarkable.
9	**affordable**	The city needs more affordable housing.
10	**sustainable**	The farm uses sustainable methods.
11	**possible**	Is it possible to pay by card?
12	**responsible**	Who is responsible for the keys?
13	**accessible**	The building is accessible by wheelchair.
14	**flexible**	The working hours are flexible.
15	**visible**	The sign is clearly visible from the road.
16	**eligible**	Only full-time students are eligible.
17	**incredible**	The museum has an incredible collection.
18	**sensible**	Wear sensible shoes for the walk.
19	**compatible**	The software is compatible with most laptops.
20	**noticeable**	There was a noticeable change in the weather.

Answers: Day 4

Ex 4.1: 1 necessary · 2 ordinary · 3 temporary · 4 vocabulary · 5 library · 6 stationery · 7 machinery · 8 delivery · 9 discovery · 10 recovery · 11 anniversary · 12 secretary · 13 dictionary · 14 bakery · 15 gallery · 16 battery · 17 factory · 18 history · 19 laboratory · 20 entry

Ex 4.2: 1 stationary · 2 stationery · 3 diary · 4 dairy · 5 metres · 6 meter · 7 programme · 8 program

Ex 4.3: 1 decision · 2 information · 3 conclusion · 4 discussion · 5 registration · 6 permission · 7 electrician · 8 television · 9 accommodation · 10 expression · 11 technician · 12 extension · 13 prescription · 14 occasion

Ex 4.4: 1 hotel · 2 travel · 3 local · 4 novel · 5 level · 6 natural · 7 mammal · 8 tunnel · 9 arrival · 10 channel · 11 festival · 12 parcel · 13 vehicle · 14 article

Ex 4.5: 1 special · 2 social · 3 official · 4 financial · 5 essential · 6 potential · 7 residential · 8 confidential · 9 economical · 10 economic · 11 historic · 12 classical

Ex 4.6: 1 famous · 2 nervous · 3 dangerous · 4 various · 5 previous · 6 obvious · 7 anxious · 8 serious · 9 delicious · 10 conscious · 11 gorgeous · 12 courageous · 13 enormous · 14 continuous

Ex 4.7: 1 colour · 2 behaviour · 3 neighbour · 4 doctor · 5 visitor · 6 director · 7 manager · 8 seminar · 9 calendar · 10 grammar · 11 guitar · 12 instructor

Ex 4.8: 1 centre · 2 meter · 3 kilometres · 4 theatre · 5 register · 6 analyse · 7 advertise · 8 exercise · 9 carefully · 10 skilful · 11 successful · 12 beautiful

Assessment: 1 c · 2 a · 3 b · 4 c · 5 a · 6 b · 7 c · 8 a · 9 b · 10 b · 11 conclusion · 12 electrician · 13 mammal · 14 delicious · 15 behaviour · 16 seminar · 17 beautiful · 18 practical · 19 famous · 20 successful

Dictation 4 script:

#	Answer	Audio script
1	**necessary**	It is not necessary to book.
2	**temporary**	She has a temporary job in a shop.
3	**vocabulary**	Write new vocabulary in a notebook.
4	**library**	The library closes at nine.
5	**stationery**	Buy your stationery at the campus shop.
6	**machinery**	Farm machinery can be dangerous.
7	**delivery**	Delivery is free on orders over thirty pounds.
8	**secretary**	Leave a message with the secretary.
9	**anniversary**	The museum celebrates its anniversary in May.
10	**laboratory**	The laboratory is on the ground floor.
11	**hospital**	The hospital is next to the park.
12	**tunnel**	The train goes through a long tunnel.
13	**financial**	You can apply for financial support.
14	**essential**	Water is essential for all life.
15	**various**	The college offers various courses.
16	**delicious**	The soup was delicious.
17	**behaviour**	The lecture is about animal behaviour.
18	**centre**	Meet me outside the sports centre.
19	**seminar**	The seminar starts at ten.
20	**analyse**	We need to analyse the data.

Answers: Day 5

Ex 5.1: 1 accommodation · 2 occurrence · 3 committee · 4 necessary · 5 successful · 6 beginning · 7 address · 8 parallel · 9 millennium · 10 embarrass · 11 recommend · 12 tomorrow · 13 disappear · 14 occasion · 15 opportunity · 16 professional ·

17 questionnaire · 18 mammal · 19 football · 20 different

Ex 5.2: 1 beginning · 2 occurred · 3 referred · 4 visited · 5 travelled · 6 cancelling · 7 opening · 8 planning · 9 preferred · 10 developed · 11 admitted · 12 listening

Ex 5.3: 1 island (s) · 2 receipt (p) · 3 Wednesday (d) · 4 knowledge (k) · 5 autumn (n) · 6 doubt (b) · 7 rhythm (h) · 8 listen (t) · 9 foreign (g) · 10 psychology (p) · 11 mortgage (t) · 12 honest (h) · 13 campaign (g) · 14 guarantee (u) · 15 February (r) · 16 business (i)

Ex 5.4: 1 believe · 2 receive · 3 ceiling · 4 leisure · 5 achieve · 6 receipt · 7 field · 8 weight · 9 neighbour · 10 piece · 11 foreign · 12 science · 13 chief · 14 height · 15 efficient · 16 seize · 17 weird · 18 relief · 19 deceive · 20 ancient

Ex 5.5: 1 meet · 2 meat · 3 weather · 4 whether · 5 week · 6 weak · 7 delayed · 8 paid · 9 mountains · 10 shower · 11 amount · 12 pronunciation

Ex 5.6: 1 accommodation · 2 receive · 3 separate · 4 government · 5 environment · 6 business · 7 tomorrow · 8 questionnaire · 9 restaurant · 10 February · 11 privilege · 12 until

Assessment: 1 a · 2 b · 3 c · 4 a · 5 b · 6 a · 7 b · 8 c · 9 b · 10 a · 11 achieve · 12 ceiling · 13 leisure · 14 believe · 15 foreign · 16 government · 17 business · 18 tomorrow · 19 rhythm · 20 until

Dictation 5 script:

#	Answer	Audio script
1	**accommodation**	Accommodation is included in the price.
2	**committee**	The committee meets every month.
3	**successful**	The project was very successful.
4	**beginning**	Please arrive at the beginning of the class.
5	**address**	What is your home address?
6	**recommend**	I recommend the fish.
7	**restaurant**	The restaurant is on the top floor.
8	**business**	She runs a small business.
9	**queue**	There was a long queue at the bank.
10	**questionnaire**	Please complete the questionnaire.
11	**receive**	You will receive an email tomorrow.
12	**receipt**	Keep your receipt.
13	**leisure**	The leisure centre has a swimming pool.
14	**separate**	Keep the two groups separate.
15	**environment**	We must protect the environment.
16	**government**	The government has introduced new rules.
17	**Wednesday**	The meeting is on Wednesday.
18	**rhythm**	Listen to the rhythm of the music.
19	**knowledge**	You need basic knowledge of computers.
20	**colleague**	My colleague will help you.

Answers: Day 6

Ex 6.1: 1 seminar · 2 bibliography · 3 furnished · 4 refrigerator · 5 vacancy · 6 personnel · 7 souvenir · 8 pedestrian · 9 protein · 10 prescription · 11 drought · 12 satellite · 13 exhibition · 14 signature · 15 furniture

Ex 6.2: 1 deposit · 2 utilities · 3 terraced · 4 landlord · 5 wardrobe · 6 employee · 7 vacancy · 8 pension · 9 excursion · 10 brochure · 11 prescription · 12 habitat · 13 drought · 14 password · 15 statue · 16 cloakroom · 17 surname · 18 occupation · 19 voucher · 20 plumber

Ex 6.3: 1 ✓ · 2 ✓ · 3 ✓ (American spelling is accepted; the British form is *neighbourhood*, so stay consistent) · 4 deposit · 5 utilities · 6 receptionist · 7 ✓ · 8 interview · 9 luggage (uncountable) · 10 reservation · 11 vegetarian · 12 appointment · 13 ✓ · 14 admission · 15 catalogue · **The student's score: 5 / 15.** Ten marks were lost to spelling alone.

Assessment: 1 a · 2 c · 3 b · 4 a · 5 c · 6 a · 7 b · 8 c · 9 b · 10 a · 11 bibliography · 12 dissertation · 13 pedestrian · 14 reservation · 15 symptom · 16 biodiversity · 17 aquarium · 18 invoice · 19 warranty · 20 cashier

Dictation 6 script:

#	Answer	Audio script
1	**itinerary**	Here is a copy of your itinerary.
2	**departure**	The departure time is ten fifteen.
3	**luggage**	Leave your luggage at the hotel.
4	**souvenir**	I bought a souvenir for my sister.
5	**pedestrian**	Drivers must stop for every pedestrian.
6	**lecture**	The lecture has been moved to Room 4.
7	**assignment**	The assignment is due on Friday.
8	**bibliography**	Add a bibliography at the end.
9	**dissertation**	Your dissertation must be eight thousand words.
10	**landlord**	The landlord will fix the window.
11	**deposit**	You pay a deposit of two hundred pounds.
12	**neighbourhood**	It is a quiet neighbourhood.
13	**recruitment**	Speak to the recruitment manager.
14	**salary**	The salary is paid every month.
15	**nutrition**	The talk is about nutrition.
16	**prescription**	Take this prescription to the pharmacy.
17	**vegetarian**	Is there a vegetarian option?
18	**habitat**	The forest is a natural habitat for birds.
19	**biodiversity**	The island has rich biodiversity.
20	**conservation**	She works in wildlife conservation.
21	**password**	Choose a strong password.
22	**satellite**	The data comes from a satellite.
23	**exhibition**	The exhibition opens on Monday.
24	**sculpture**	The sculpture is made of bronze.
25	**surname**	Could you spell your surname?
26	**occupation**	What is your occupation?
27	**voucher**	You can use this voucher in any branch.
28	**jewellery**	The jewellery is kept in a glass case.
29	**warranty**	The fridge has a two-year warranty.

#	Answer	Audio script
30	**physiotherapy**	He needs physiotherapy for his knee.

Answers: Day 7

Ex 7.1: 1 buses · 2 boxes · 3 cities · 4 days · 5 knives · 6 roofs · 7 potatoes · 8 photos · 9 children · 10 people · 11 women · 12 teeth · 13 mice · 14 sheep · 15 species · 16 crises · 17 criteria · 18 phenomena · 19 analyses · 20 bacteria · 21 cacti · 22 curricula (or curriculums) · 23 passers-by · 24 mothers-in-law · 25 spoonfuls

Ex 7.2: 1 more information · 2 two useful pieces of advice / some useful advice · 3 All sports equipment is provided · 4 modern furniture · 5 your luggage · 6 accommodation · 7 a lot of research / several research projects · 8 a lot of homework · 9 all my schoolwork · 10 Her knowledge of history is · 11 There is a lot of traffic · 12 no evidence · 13 your feedback · 14 The software is · 15 Here is the news

Ex 7.3: 1 lectures · 2 student · 3 problems · 4 week · 5 residents · 6 room · 7 photos · 8 gloves · 9 option · 10 options · 11 space · 12 tourists · 13 person · 14 children · 15 activities · 16 sheep · 17 tomatoes · 18 shelves · 19 equipment · 20 hundred

Ex 7.4: 1 is · 2 are · 3 is · 4 are · 5 were · 6 is · 7 are · 8 is · 9 are · 10 *are* is more formal (*data* as the plural of *datum*); *is* is common in everyday English

Ex 7.5: 1 a ten-minute walk · 2 a three-day course · 3 a two-bedroom flat · 4 a five-star hotel · 5 a seven-year-old boy · 6 a twenty-pound note · 7 a two-hour lecture · 8 a 20-page report

Assessment: 1 facilities · 2 shelves · 3 hypotheses · 4 aircraft · 5 videos · 6 ✗ a five-day holiday · 7 ✓ · 8 ✗ three hundred visitors · 9 ✓ · 10 ✗ a lot of luggage · 11 rooms · 12 equipment · 13 minute · 14 advice · 15 fruit · 16 member · 17 volunteers · 18 belongings · 19 deer · 20 headquarters

Dictation 7 script:

#	Answer	Audio script
1	**exhibitions**	There are three new exhibitions this month.
2	**photos**	Please bring two passport photos.
3	**information**	We need more information about the course.
4	**ten-minute**	The hotel is a ten-minute walk from the beach.
5	**sheep**	The farm keeps about two hundred sheep.
6	**species**	Scientists found three new species of frog.
7	**equipment**	All sports equipment is provided.
8	**children**	Tickets are half price for children.
9	**shelves**	The room has two shelves for books.
10	**accommodation**	The fee includes accommodation and meals.
11	**criteria**	Applications are judged on four criteria.
12	**tourists**	The town is popular with tourists in summer.
13	**furniture**	The flat comes with furniture.
14	**potatoes**	Add two potatoes to the soup.
15	**leaves**	In autumn, the leaves turn red.
16	**scissors**	You will need a pair of scissors.
17	**feedback**	Your tutor will give you feedback on Friday.
18	**months**	The course lasts six months.
19	**desks**	There are twenty desks in the classroom.

#	Answer	Audio script
20	**costs**	The price covers all travel costs.

Answers: Final Mastery Test

Section 1: see the script below.

Section 2: 1 b · 2 b · 3 a · 4 c · 5 a · 6 b · 7 a · 8 c · 9 b · 10 a

Section 3: 11 library · 12 pleasant · 13 identification · 14 government · 15 available · 16 queue · 17 reference · 18 excellent · 19 address · 20 temporary

Section 4: 21 significant · 22 existence · 23 flexible · 24 machinery · 25 convenience · 26 attendance · 27 suitable · 28 vocabulary · 29 consistent · 30 eligible

Section 5: 31 galleries · 32 luggage · 33 month · 34 mice · 35 criteria · 36 species · 37 information · 38 shelves · 39 potatoes · 40 visitor

Final Test dictation script:

#	Answer	Audio script
1	**accommodation**	Student accommodation is close to the campus.
2	**convenient**	Is Thursday convenient for you?
3	**maintenance**	The maintenance team will come on Monday.
4	**available**	The room is available from June.
5	**responsible**	You are responsible for your own equipment.
6	**necessary**	A visa is not necessary.
7	**stationery**	Stationery is sold on the first floor.
8	**receipt**	Please keep the receipt.
9	**questionnaire**	The questionnaire takes ten minutes.
10	**independent**	We are an independent travel company.
11	**experience**	No experience is needed for this job.
12	**guarantee**	The watch has a one-year guarantee.
13	**itinerary**	Your itinerary will be sent by email.
14	**laboratory**	Safety glasses must be worn in the laboratory.
15	**environment**	The course looks at the marine environment.
16	**separate**	Recycling must be kept separate.
17	**physiotherapy**	Physiotherapy sessions start next week.
18	**recommend**	Which hotel would you recommend?
19	**appearance**	The town has changed its appearance.
20	**species**	This species is now endangered.

Answers: Real Answer Words dictations

The words in each block, in the order the audio reads them.

Block 1:

1. dance
2. insects
3. parking
4. cinema

5. database
6. furniture
7. week
8. grass
9. animal
10. garden
11. training
12. brain
13. stress
14. family
15. dentist
16. food
17. map
18. floor
19. bridge

Block 2:

1. park
2. boots
3. balance
4. clouds
5. personality
6. cattle
7. behaviour
8. bay
9. beginners
10. breathing
11. sugar
12. time
13. location
14. oxygen
15. bone
16. market
17. river
18. healthy
19. appointment

Block 3:

1. confusion
2. film
3. competition
4. college
5. deliveries
6. experience
7. dog
8. dry
9. dark
10. equipment
11. colour
12. fishing
13. diary
14. employment
15. complex
16. entry
17. customer
18. fence
19. disease

Block 4:

1. logic
2. lamps
3. island
4. helmet
5. insurance
6. glass
7. metal
8. harbour
9. late
10. hospital
11. history
12. leader
13. lunch
14. ice
15. instrument
16. heavy
17. lighting
18. light
19. fuel

Block 5:

1. oil
2. movement
3. problem
4. plastic
5. migration
6. play
7. perfume
8. price
9. political
10. mud
11. poster
12. paper
13. rain
14. presentation

15. passport
16. newspaper
17. payment
18. museum
19. power

Block 6:

1. safety
2. sky
3. structure
4. soil
5. reproduction
6. study
7. social
8. rose
9. salt
10. stage
11. relative
12. smartphone
13. steam
14. side
15. September
16. review
17. speed
18. roads
19. space

Block 7:

1. women
2. tube
3. wall
4. trains
5. wood
6. tent
7. temporary
8. vision
9. style
10. tail
11. windows
12. suit
13. tree
14. tool
15. transport
16. Thursday
17. technical
18. weight

Log Trackers and Error Log

7-Day Score Tracker

Day	Date	Exercises (✓ / total)	Dictation	Assessment	Answer words	Words to review
1 · -ant / -ent		/ 69	/ 20	/ 20	/ 19	
2 · -ance / -ence		/ 70	/ 20	/ 20	/ 19	
3 · -able / -ible		/ 62	/ 20	/ 20	/ 19	
4 · -ary / -ery and more		/ 106	/ 20	/ 20	/ 19	
5 · double, silent, vowels		/ 92	/ 20	/ 20	/ 19	
6 · vocabulary bank		/ 50	/ 30	/ 20	/ 19	
7 · singular and plural		/ 78	/ 20	/ 20	/ 18	
Final Mastery Test			/ 20	**/ 60**		

After the workbook: spaced review

When	What to do
Day 8	Take the Final Mastery Test.
Day 9	Re-learn every word in the Error Log (Look-Say-Cover-Write-Check).
Day 10	Play Dictations 1–7 again. Write only the words, with no sentences.
Day 14	Do Exercise 7.3 and the Day 6 Assessment again.
Days 8–21	Real Answer Words Part B: one or two letters a day.
Day 21	Play the Final Test dictation again. Aim for 20/20.
Every test	Add new Listening spelling mistakes to section 8 of your Spelling Fix List, so they go into the weekly spelling test.

Error Log

Write every word you get wrong. Test it again after **1, 3 and 7 days** and tick the box when you get it right.

Date	❌ I wrote	✅ Correct	Rule or trick (Day / Part)	Day 1	Day 3	Day 7
				☐	☐	☐
				☐	☐	☐
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